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Wellington & District
LEADER
Covering news and views from within the Wellington, Eucharanea, Geurie, Goolma, Gollan, Mumbil, Stuart Town, Wongarbon and Yeoval districts.
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\$2.50
Inc GST

WELLINGTON RACE CLUB

NEXT MEETING
TUESDAY
26 MAY
Full TAB Meeting
Racing at its Best

More
Boot
photos
- P 4

Welcome
to our
new local citizens - P 5

Redbacks
Under 12s
success in
Armidale -
P14

It's taken four years



IT'S ONLY taken four years, but remediation of the floodway over Showground Road at Pioneer Park is finally being completed.

In the 12 months to November 2022 the Bell River flooded 11 times, creatng havoc along its path and finally eroding a land barrier dividing it from the Macquarie River and taking out the Gobolion Road-way leading onto the Duke of Wellington Bridge.

While funding for that road replacement has been found, many more millions are

needed to contract a barrier against further floods in both the Macquarie and Bell Rivers.

While Council has not commented, it seemed the delay was due to the roads department not wanting responsibility for the damage.

In the meantime, there have been delays in remediating the floodway on Showground Road at Pioneer Park, but funds were recently allocated to fix the 600 square metres of road shoulder and roadside verge.

Work began on Monday and after levelling, a concrete causeway was laid to enable future floodwaters easier flow across the road and onto the Park.

Council said the works remain ongoing, and are part of an \$87,000 NSW Government Disaster Recovery Funding Arrangements grant to repair flood damaged Council transport assets.

The remediation will now allow pedestrians to safely walk along Showground Road to the Bell River bridge giving access from the town west.

In an earlier announcement, Council was successful in winning a \$437,000 grant from the NSW Government for concreting the existing gravel cyclist/pedestrian path from Showground Road and Renshaw McGirr Way corner along to Bushrangers Creek Road towards Mount Arthur.

This is funded under Minister for Regional Transport Jenny Aitchison's 'Road Safety Program'.

The installation of the shared path will help to increase safety and reduce road traffic accidents.

Inside
this
week

Yeoval in limelight as
local cattle stud exceeds
bull and heifer sale
expectations - Page 15

2026 Biennial Community Insights survey results

Dubbo Regional Council has undertaken a Community Insights Survey every two years since 2016 to measure overall community satisfaction with Council's performance and identify emerging priorities and needs.

This consultation activity supports Council's Integrated Planning and Reporting (IP&R) Framework, with survey questions designed to inform the development of future Delivery Programs and Operational Plans, while also measuring satisfaction across Council facilities and services.

Overall, 85 per cent of residents are at least somewhat satisfied with the performance of Council over the past 12 months (81pc in 2024).

Council management and planning remains the most important driver of overall satisfaction. Roads and infrastructure (e.g., waste management, water supply) are also key drivers.

Despite these positive results, some areas that may require closer attention, include:

- Roads: Road maintenance received the lowest satisfaction ratings (below 60pc) and is the strongest driver of overall satisfaction with Council. It was also the most frequently mentioned priority for the next 10

years. Improving communication about planned maintenance and investment in the road network may help lift satisfaction in this key area.

- Community safety: Community safety is a large contributor to quality of life in the LGA. Although the perception that 'the LGA is a safe place to live, work and play' has improved compared with 2024, the results remain lower than the MMX Regional Benchmark, with almost one in five residents raising concerns about safety and homelessness. Strengthening communication and visibility around community safety initiatives may help build confidence in this area.

- Growth and housing: More than 20pc of residents identified infrastructure to support population growth, along with housing availability and affordability, as key issues needing attention. Responding to these pressures will be important maintaining liveability as the region grows.

Moving forward, as residents seek improved service levels, Council has an opportunity to strengthen engagement by clearly communicating its plans for road maintenance, community safety, and

infrastructure to support growth. Doing so is likely to enhance resident satisfaction and overall quality of life.

Cemetery clean up

Council teams have been out this week cleaning and maintaining regional cemeteries in readiness for any visitors on ANZAC Day.

You can assist the team caring for these spaces by following guidelines on permitted placement of flowers and tributes and returning to collect any items again.

We encourage visiting friends and families to tidy plots of loved ones while there, especially after storm events when tributes can be damaged. If you notice anything needing attention you can submit a request or report through our DRC&ME Portal, calling 6801 4000, or by visiting Councils Front Desk.

Have your say

Dubbo Regional Council has a number of items currently open for public view or comment, including:

- * Disability Inclusion Action Plan Review
- * Corporate Website Redevelopment Survey

* Notice of Land Classification

Join the conversation and have your say now at: <https://yoursay.dubbo.nsw.gov.au/> To stay informed, register to follow a particular project, program and activity listing that is important to you at YourSay.

Hydrogen aviation testing at Bodangora Airstrip

WELLINGTON AERODROME and Recreational Park is a hub for aerospace testing, training and aviation activities, supporting both recreational aviation and emerging aviation technologies.

Following our approval, liquid hydrogen will be used at the facility.

The approval allows AMSL Aero to continue testing its Vertii test vehicle, supporting the development of hydrogen-powered aircraft designed to deliver long-range, zero emission flight.

AMSL Aero has been undertaking on-the-ground testing at the Wellington Aerodrome of their hydrogen-electric vertical take-off and landing (eVTOL) aircraft, which has been designed to take off like a helicopter and transition to efficient wing-borne flight.

Josh Black

Tree planting day with REACT centre has a new address

Mid Macquarie

Landcare

Plant a tree- Grow a future

MID MACQUARIE Landcare is conducting a community planting event and would love to see you there to plant a tree and grow a future.

As part of Mid Macquarie Landcare's Healthy Cities Project, you will be contributing to the 2000 native species being planted across Police Paddock and Biddybunge Reserve in Dubbo.

It is thanks to Bupa's generosity, that we have been able to make this

project happen.

Join us for a rewarding morning of revegetation and shared knowledge, not forgetting a reptile show provided by Wambangalang Environmental Education Centre.

There will also be a raffle for all participants.

Details are listed in our advertisement, registration essential.

Reach out for any further information to Aisling Campbell 0404 350 786.

A KEY piece of the region's renewable energy future has been secured with Council purchasing 93 Simpson Street, Wellington as the new home for the Renewable Energy Awareness and Career Training (REACT) Centre.

The acquisition unlocks the next phase of the project, allowing Council to shift REACT from concept to concrete plans.

The project received an \$11.24 million EnergyCo Community and Employment Benefit Program grant for legacy, Council-led projects.

The grant is part of the NSW Government's initial \$128 million investment to share benefits with communities during the delivery of the Central-West Orana Renewable Energy Zone.

With the land now secured, Council will move into detailed design and delivery, setting the course for a landmark regional facility located behind Wellington TAFE expected to open by 2028. When completed the REACT Centre is expected to provide a powerful advantage for residents of the region when it supports employment, attracts industry and prepares residents for future jobs. Council's acting general manager Luke Ryan said acquiring the site was a major milestone in the development of the REACT Centre.

"With the site now secured, we're excited to begin detailed design of the facility and, in due course, break ground for its construction.

"Having the REACT Centre within this region allows our community to have an active role in the Central West Orana Renewable Energy Zone.

"The training that will be offered at this centre in the future will be opportune for our young people, allowing them to stay here, in their community, while they grow and educate themselves for future jobs," Mr Ryan said.

EnergyCo chief executive officer Hannah McCaughey said the REACT Centre would play a key role in supporting access to jobs and training in the renewable energy sector across Central-West Orana.

"The REACT Centre will support locals who want to build careers in renewable energy, giving them access to targeted training and a pathway into an industry that's already creating real jobs in the region.

"With more than 500 locals already working on the transmission project and thousands more jobs expected during construction and operation, there are significant opportunities ahead for Central-West Orana communities.

"EnergyCo is pleased to support the REACT Centre and deliver legacy outcomes through the Community and Employment Benefit Program."

The REACT project is a Council-led initiative designed to support workforce development and long-term economic benefits arising from the

Central West Orana Renewable Energy Zone and broader renewable energy development across regional NSW.

Delivering the centre in Wellington - the heart of NSW's first Renewable Energy Zone - positions the community to directly benefit from the energy transition through skills development, training infrastructure, and employment pathways.

Industry partners Squadron Energy, ACEREZ, Lightsource bp and Tilt Renewables were key funding partners for the business case provided to EnergyCo's REZ Legacy Infrastructure Fund.

The land, former Michael White & Company CRT merchants, was purchased by Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club for the purpose of community accommodation however, Council bought the block specifically for the REACT project.

...See Western Freezing Works story Page 13.

Wellington & District LEADER

In Memory of Beryl O'Brien

Covering news and views particularly from within the Wellington region, which now runs from Euchareena to Elong Elong within Dubbo Regional Council Local Government Area.

Wellington & District Leader is independently published locally by Mark Griggs and Sharon Wilson trading as Wellington District Leader, 14 Nancarrow Lane, Wellington, NSW, 2820, ABN: 26847723165 and printed by Gilgandra Newspapers, another independent and both members of CPNSW.

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Community input and feedback is welcomed. Story leads, prepared articles and photographs can be forwarded to the publisher.

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**SATURDAY 2ND
MAY 2026**

**LANDCARE
AUSTRALIA**

Plant a Tree, Grow a Future!



Help to add more habitat and shade to Dubbo through our local community planting day. A chance to give back to your community and local area through our Healthy Cities Project where we are planting 2000 native species in Dubbo!

- All equipment provided
- All holes are pre dug
- Lunch provided
- Local reptile show and giveaways included

Registration required, please contact us via the details listed below.

TIME	LOCATION
9AM - 1:30PM	POLICE PADDOCK - NEAR THE INTERSECTION OF MYALL ST AND BRISBANE ST, DUBBO.

FOR MORE INFORMATION CONTACT -
AISLING@MML.ORG.AU

0404350786 - AISLING CAMPBELL





National
Fuel Security
Plan

To keep Australia moving, the government has been working to secure fuel supply and has put in place the 4-level National Fuel Security Plan.

We're now at Level 2. So, consider simple actions to use less fuel, like using your car less.

Every little bit helps

For fuel saving tips, visit fuelplan.gov.au



National Fuel Security Plan



Australian Government

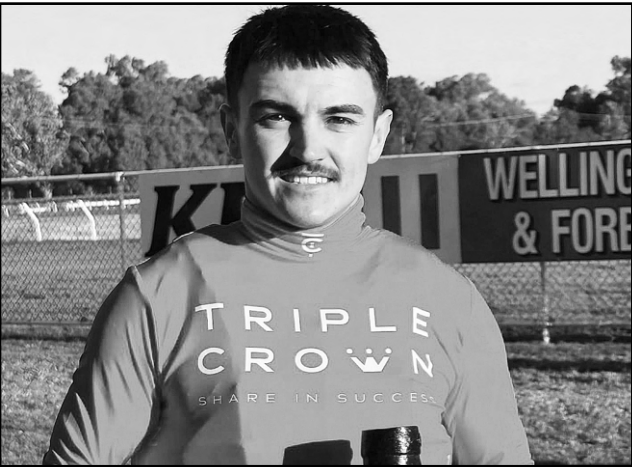
More photos from the 2026 Wellington Boot carnival



The late Peter Milling’s three daughters presented the Peter Milling Memorial Wellington Cup to connections of the winner, Perfumist ridden by Liberty Smyth and trained by Bjorn Baker.



Trainer Jane Clement leads her Wellington Town Plate winner Chandon Star after the race.



Rider of the 2026 Wellington Boot winner, Hellenic Belle, is jockey Braith Nock.



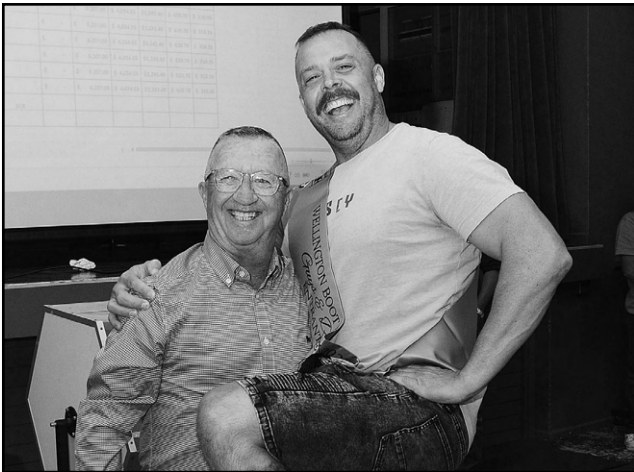
The three daughters of the late Peter Milling attended the running of Peter’s Memorial Wellington Cup race won by Perfumist.



Shannen Llewellyn gives a victory ‘thumbs up’ after her win in the Town Plate on Chandon Star.



These ‘Boot’ goers deserve credit for their racing attire with different themes each year.



Miracle Mal Johnston was beaten for size by Guys & Dolls entrant Ben Hessessey when he presented sashes at the Calcutta.



Co-owners among connections to the Wellington Boot winner Hellenic Belle posed with the coveted Boot trophy after the race presentations.



with Mathew Dickerson, Axxis Comworld

BACK IN 1998, when we were building our house, wireless networking felt more like science fiction than something you’d rely on. The term Wi-Fi didn’t appear until 1999 so, like any self-respecting tech enthusiast of the time, I went all in on cables. Cat 5 network cables ran through every wall, terminating neatly in a communications cupboard alongside a then cutting-edge home automation system. It was meticulous, slightly obsessive, and - at the time - completely logical. Fast forward nearly three decades, and one of those cables decided to stop working. I spent hours tracing connections, re-terminating plugs, and peering into roof spaces, convinced I’d solve it myself. Eventually, I called in a professional. He arrived with a device that looked like something out of a sci-fi toolkit - a Time Domain Reflectometer. Within minutes, this device pinpointed the exact location of the fault inside the wall. Minutes. After my hours. The difference between a professional and

4 THURSDAY, APRIL 23, 2026 WELLINGTON & DISTRICT LEADER

a keen amateur is often the tools. Which brings me, perhaps unexpectedly, to the kitchen. We don’t often think of cooking as a high-tech pursuit, but it’s quietly becoming one. And one of the more intriguing developments is the arrival of ultrasonic cutting tools in the home - specifically, a new ultrasonic chef’s knife designed for everyday use. Now, before your mind jumps to a plasma energy blade, this isn’t a mini lightsaber that Luke Skywalker would use when making dinner. Ultrasonic cutting tools have actually been around for years in professional settings, typically as bench-mounted devices. Bakers use them to slice delicate cakes without squashing them. Food processors use them to cut sticky or frozen products cleanly. Even surgeons rely on ultrasonic tools for precision work. The principle is surprisingly simple. Instead of relying purely on sharpness and

downward force, the blade vibrates at an incredibly high frequency - around 33,000 times per second. These tiny, rapid oscillations reduce friction as the blade moves through food. The result? Less resistance, less sticking, and a cleaner cut. What’s new is that this technology is now being packaged into something that looks and feels like a regular kitchen knife. These knives combine traditional high-quality steel with a built-in ultrasonic motor powered by a small rechargeable battery. Switch the ultrasonic mode on, and suddenly slicing through a tomato, a loaf of fresh bread, or even a sticky piece of cheese requires noticeably less effort. It’s not just about ease, though. There’s a subtle shift in the quality of the cut. Foods that might normally compress or tear - think soft cakes or ripe fruit - are sliced cleanly, preserving texture and presentation. Less food sticks to the blade, which also means less time spent cleaning up.

What’s particularly clever is that these knives are designed to feel familiar. The vibration is largely imperceptible in the handle, and when switched off, they behave like any well-made chef’s knife. So where does this lead? If history is any guide, today’s “interesting but niche” technology often becomes tomorrow’s standard. Just as Wi-Fi moved from an expensive curiosity to an invisible utility we barely think about, tools like ultrasonic knives may quietly reshape everyday tasks. Of course, not every home cook needs an ultrasonic knife - just as not every household needed Cat 5 cabling in 1998. But for those who value efficiency, precision, or simply enjoy well-designed tools, it’s another step in the steady evolution of the modern kitchen. After all, whether it’s diagnosing a hidden cable fault or cutting the perfect piece of cake, the right tool can make all the difference between professional and amateur.



Australia and Wellington’s new citizens pledged their allegiance to Australia at a ceremony in the Civic Centre recently.

WELLINGTON and the Dubbo Region welcomed 15 new citizens after they made their pledge to Australia, officially becoming Australian citizens in Wellington at the Civic Centre on Tuesday, April 7.

The Mayor Josh Black with deputy mayor Phillip Toynton and Federal Member for Calare Andrew Gee welcomed new citizens from three countries (Philippines, Ireland and USA).



Making it easier for NSW women to access the pill

LIFE HAS been made a little easier for women over the age of 18 to access the pill after the state government investment of \$1.4 million to allow eligible pharmacists to prescribe it directly.

This means women will be able to access the pill quickly through their eligible local pharmacy, without needing to book a GP appointment.

The reform will take pressure off GPs while giving women faster, more convenient access to care.

This expansion builds on the success of the oral contraceptive pill resupply clinical trial which began in September 2023.

To date, 773 pharmacies are registered with Healthdirect to provide this resupply service in NSW.

The state government will pay for the first 5000 consultations with a trained pharmacist, and once this is exhausted it is expected to cost between \$20 -

\$60 for a consultation.

Pharmacists trained with a graduate certificate from James Cook University will be able to prescribe contraception for women at lower risk of complications, and after the participation in a NSW induction to reproductive health course.

It is anticipated that up to 60 pharmacists will be eligible to start, with more pharmacists coming online as they complete the graduate certificate.

Participating community pharmacists will be able to resupply additional contraceptive options, including:

- * Additional oral contraceptive pills
- * The medroxyprogesterone acetate injection
- * The combined hormonal contraceptive ring.

The Pharmacy Board of Australia will also be releasing national guidelines on endorsed pharmacist prescribers.

Once endorsed by all Health Ministers, Universities will be able to apply to have their courses accredited and pharmacists who have undertaken appropriate training will have an endorsement on their registration.

This reform is about removing the time, cost and hassle that too often gets in the way of women accessing basic healthcare.

These initiatives complement broader measures introduced by the state Labor Government to make healthcare more accessible and affordable for individuals and families including:

- * Ensuring GPs can diagnose ADHD and provide treatment, as well as provide continuation of medication for patients;
- * Expanding the treatment services available in pharmacy including for uncomplicated UTI's and common skin conditions.



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Yin Yoga 9:30am first Sunday each month
Restorative Yoga - 9am third Sunday each month
Tai Chi 9:30am every Friday

Empathetic Counselling

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www.tharpachoeeling.org



Wellington Buddhist Centre

Tharpa Choeling Australia



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Monday, Wednesday & Friday
from 8:30 – 12:00pm

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Simone McManus

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Wellington
02 6845 1976



Wellington Baptist Church

ALL WELCOME

Join us for Sunday Service
Sunday 9:30am, Pastor Rudolph Kock
Mobile 0475799036

keirle's pharmacy



alliance PHARMACY

where local health matters

In honour of Anzac Day
Keirles Pharmacy will be closed
Saturday 25th April
reopen
Monday 27th April
9-12pm

We stand with our community in gratitude for the brave servicemen and women who have defended our freedoms

Thank you for your service

Lest we forget

31 Nanima Crescent, Wellington
02 6845 2059
email:keirles@alliancepharmacy.com.au * Check us out on facebook

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Public Notice

WELLINGTON BOWLING CLUB LTD
Special Meeting to all
interested past Members
Included those FYE 23/24, 24/25
Sunday 24 May 2026
2.30pm for future of Club

Water Delivery

Domestic Water Deliveries
Servicing Wellington Region
Fiona: 0427 463 441 Ken: 0427 463 442

Church Services

Anglican Parish of Wellington

WELLINGTON – St John the Baptist Church
Sunday 9am
Sunday 5pm - The Gathering
MARANATHA
11am on 2nd & 4th Friday of month.

Wellington Baptist Church

77 Swift Street
9:30am Sunday mornings
6pm Evening Service

Wellington Uniting Church

Sunday at 9.30am

St Patrick’s Catholic Parish

Saturday
5pm – Mass, St Patrick’s Church, Wellington
8.30am - Stuart Town

Sunday
8am – Our Lady’s Church, Yeoval first, third and fifth Sundays of the month
10am – Our Lady’s Church, Yeoval second and fourth Sundays of the month
10am – St Patrick’s Church, Wellington first, third and fifth Sundays of the month
8am – St Patrick’s Church, Wellington second and fourth Sundays of the month

Weekday mass
Please check parish bulletin

In Christ Chapel
2pm Sunday

Everyone looks at the classifieds.

Promote your

Annual General Meetings, Social Club Events,

Birthday Parties

Homes and Flats to rent or wanted to rent

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Garage Sale

Memorium

Public Notice

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Wellington & District
LEADER

Tell our advertisers you saw it in the ‘Leader’

Around the electorate

with our State Member **Dugald Saunders**



ANZAC Services
ANZAC Day services will take place across the Dubbo electorate on Saturday, 25 April.
Wellington
DAWN: 5.45am – Ex-Servicemen and Women March from Soldiers Memorial Club | 6am – Dawn Service at Cameron Park
DAY: 10.45am – March begins from the corner of Lee and Gisborne streets | 10.55am – ANZAC Day Service at the Cameron Park Cenotaph
DUSK: 3.10pm – Dusk Service at Cameron Park

Stuart Town
DAWN: 5.45am – Dawn Service
DAY: 10.45am – March begins from Railway Station | 11am – ANZAC Day Service
DUSK: 5.45pm – Sunset Service

Mumbil: 8.45am

Gollan: 11am

Geurie: 8.40am

Dubbo
DAWN: 5.45am – Dawn Service at the Victoria Park Cenotaph
DAY: 10.15am – March begins from Dubbo RSL on Wingewarra Street | 11am – ANZAC Day Service at the Victoria Park Cenotaph

Narromine
DAWN: 5.45am – Dawn Service at the Narromine Cenotaph
DAY: 9.30am – Commonwealth War Graves Ceremony at Narromine Cemetery | 10.30am – March participants assemble at the Narromine USMC | 11.00am – ANZAC Day Service at the Narromine Cenotaph

Community Building Partnerships
Not-for-profit community organisations and local councils in the Dubbo electorate are invited to express their interest in the 2026 Community Building Partnerships (CBP) program.
Grants between \$10,000 and \$100,000 are available to deliver capital works to upgrade existing and/or construct new community infrastructure, or the purchase of freestanding equipment and registered vehicles to support the delivery of community services.
NOTE: the application process for 2026 is a little different from previous CBP rounds and now starts with the requirement to submit an Expression of Interest (EOI) detailing who the project will benefit and how it aligns with local electorate priorities.
Eligible organisations can submit up to 2 EOIs for each electorate.
EOIs must be submitted by 5pm, Friday 8 May. For more, including 2026 Grant Guidelines and Dubbo electorate priorities, visit: nsw.gov.au/cbp .

Women in Ag workshop
Women working in Agriculture are invited to attend the free Safer Futures workshop on 1 May.
The program is funded by NSW SafeWork and is designed to provide women working in agriculture with practical information and tools to strengthen safety, wellbeing and leadership on farm.
WHEN: Friday 1 May, 9am to 3pm
WHERE: Roseville Park Merino Stud - 39 Dilladerry Road, Wambangalang
Register your attendance at: <https://events.humanitix.com/dubbo-women-in-agriculture-leader-safer-futures>

Graduate opportunity
Applications are open for emerging professionals to participate in Essential Energy’s 2027 Graduate Program.
More than 20 graduates will be recruited into permanent roles, offering mentoring, rotations and hands-on experience to help shape the future of energy across regional, rural and remote NSW. Opportunities are available in electrical engineering, AI, digital and data, cyber security, and procurement.
If you’re interested in building a brilliant career and making a real community impact across NSW and southern QLD, lodge your application by Sunday, 10 May, at: www.essentialenergy.com.au/graduate-program

Until next time,
Dugald

Andrew GEE MP

INDEPENDENT FEDERAL

MEMBER FOR CALARE

Your True Country
Independent



WELLINGTON BOOT CARNIVAL A CRACKER!

The Wellington Boot carnival is one of Wellington's greatest traditions and biggest weekends!

The Boot itself is a race which draws horses and race fans from all over the country!

As always, the Fashions in the Field proved popular! Congratulations to Peter Barton, the team at the Club and all the volunteers for hosting yet another awesome carnival.

It was an honour to help with the presentations, join in the fun (although my punting skills need some work!) and support this terrific community event for our region.



GRANT OPPORTUNITIES

NSW GOVERNMENT VENUE UPGRADE GRANTS

Grants are available for venues that demonstrate a commitment to increasing live music programming and may apply for grants to support advice from consultants and experts to create fit-for-purpose venues.

For further information go to:



FOUNDATION FOR RURAL REGIONAL RENEWAL

The Foundation for Rural Regional Renewal (FRRR) offers a range of grants for remote, rural, and regional communities across Australia to access funds for a broad range of initiatives that directly and clearly benefit local communities. These include grant programs for young people, communities impacted by drought and disasters, and placed based capacity building programs.

For further information go to:



CLUBGRANTS

ClubGrants are available for local community groups, sporting clubs and charities through the ClubGRANTS program:

For further information go to:



ORANGE ELECTORATE OFFICE

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Orange NSW 2800

☎ (02) 6361 7138
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🌐 www.andrewgeemp.com.au

For regular updates and news, follow me on Facebook and Instagram @andrewgeecalare



Authorised by Andrew Gee MP, Suite 1/179a Anson Street Orange NSW 2800

Insert the missing letters to make 10 words – five reading across the grid and five reading down.

O		E		S
	O		A	
E		O		E
	I		E	
N		E		S

Place each of the tiles of letters into the blank jigsaw below to create four six-letter words going across and down.

ND

ER

RG

BE

ES

ME

CA

OD

There may be more than one possible answer.

Insert each number from 1 to 9 in the shaded squares to solve all the horizontal and vertical equations. Multiplication and division are performed before addition and subtraction.

+

-

=

12

-

+

×

+

+

=

19

+

×

×

×

+

=

7

=

=

=

6

31

24

MERGES
ERODES
BECAME
BENDER

EDGEWORD

S	D	E	N	E	N
D	D	E	A	I	A
E	K	O	V	E	
L	A	R	O	C	
S	N	E	S	O	

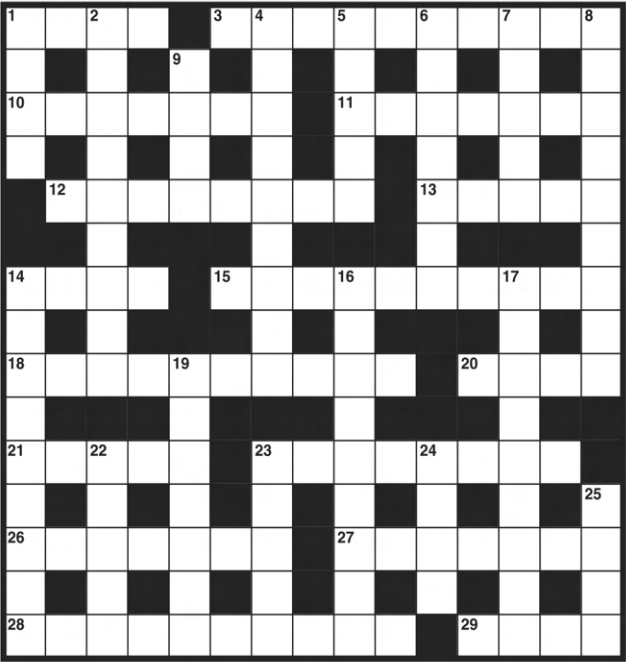
5x5

24		31		9		
=		=		=		
7	=	1	+	3	×	2
		×		×		+
61	=	9	+	8	+	5
		×		+		-
12	=	4	-	7	+	6

H1W1SS0D

9 6.00 Morning Programs. 11.00 Compass. 11.30 Songs Of Praise. 12.00 ABC News At Noon. 12.30 Landline. 1.30 Gardening Australia. 2.30 The Piano. Final. 3.25 Judgment: Cases That Changed Australia. 4.15 Grand Designs. 5.00 Back Roads. 5.30 Antiques Roadshow. 6.30 Compass. 7.00 ABC News. 7.30 The Assembly. Return. 8.15 Bad Company. New. 8.45 Bergerac. Return. 9.30 Blue Murder Motel. Final. 10.15 Top End Bub. Final. 10.40 MOVIE: Van Diemen's Land. (2009) 12.30 Late Programs.	7 6.00 NBC Today. 7.00 Weekend Sunrise. 10.00 The Morning Show: Weekend. 12.00 Sunday Footy Feast. 2.30 House Of Wellness. 3.30 Border Security: International. 4.00 Better Homes And Gardens. 5.00 Seven News At 5. 5.30 Sydney Weekender. 6.00 Seven News. 7.00 The 1% Club UK. 8.00 7NEWS Spotlight. 9.00 MOVIE: Bravery & Betrayal. (2025) 11.10 24 Hours In Police Custody. 12.10 A Friend Of The Family. 2.00 Home Shopping. 3.30 Million Dollar Minute. 4.00 Late Programs.	9 6.00 Hello SA. 6.30 A Current Affair. 7.00 Weekend Today. 10.00 Wide World Of Sports. 11.00 NRL Sunday Footy Show. 1.00 Drive TV: Drive Car Of The Year. 1.30 Reel Destinations. 2.00 Oz Off Road TV. 3.00 Rugby League. NRL. Round 8. Manly Sea Eagles v Parramatta Eels. 6.00 9News Sunday. 7.00 The Floor. 8.10 60 Minutes. 9.10 Australian Crime Stories: The Investigators. 10.15 9News Late. 10.45 The First 48. 11.40 American Ripper. New. 12.35 Oz Off Road TV. 1.30 Late Programs.	10 6.00 Mass. 6.30 Key Of David. 7.00 Joseph Prince. 7.30 Buy To Build. 8.00 Australia By Design: Architecture. 8.30 My Market Kitchen. 9.00 Freshly Picked. 9.30 Well Traveller. 10.00 Farm To Fork. 10.30 MasterChef Aust. 1.00 Dogs Behaving (Very) Badly Australia. 2.00 Deal Or No Deal. 2.30 Millionaire Hot Seat. 3.00 The Finish Line. 4.00 Lingo. 5.00 10 News. 6.30 10 News+ 7.00 MasterChef Australia. 8.35 Race Across The World. 9.50 Matlock. 10.45 NCIS: Origins. 11.35 Late Programs.	SBS 6.00 Morning Programs. 12.00 PBS News Compass Points. 12.30 WorldWatch. 1.00 Speedweek. 3.00 Cycling. UCI World Tour. Fleche-Wallonne Men's Race. H'lights. 4.00 Cycling. UCI World Tour. Fleche-Wallonne Women's Race. H'lights. 5.00 Going Places. 5.35 Cold War Spies. New. 6.30 SBS World News. 7.30 Pompeii: The New Dig. 8.40 Bettany Hughes' Lost Worlds: Nabataeans. 9.40 Emperor: Rise And Fall Of A Dynasty. 10.35 Treasures Of Egypt. 11.35 Rhoda Roberts AO: A Lasting Legacy. 1.05 Late Programs.
two 6.00 Morning Programs. 12.30 Escape To The Country. 1.30 Kochie's Business Builders. 2.00 South Aussie With Cosi. 2.30 Better Homes And Gardens. 3.30 The Yorkshire Vet. 4.30 Australia's Big Backyards. 5.30 The Aussie Property Flippers. 6.30 Escape To The Country. 7.30 The Coroner. 8.30 Vera. 10.30 Maternal. 11.30 Late Programs.	mate 6.00 Morning Programs. 2.00 Charter Boat Wars 2: Port Phillip Bay. 2.30 Al McGlashan's Fish'n With Mates. 3.00 Pawn Stars. 4.00 Counting Cars. 4.30 Football. AFL. GWS Giants v North Melbourne. 7.30 Border Security: Australia's Front Line. 8.30 MOVIE: Die Hard 2. (1990) 11.00 MOVIE: Contraband. (2012) 1.15 Late Programs.	flix 6.00 Morning Programs. 12.00 My Asian Banquet. 12.30 Home And Away. 2.30 Sean's Kitchen. 3.30 A Moveable Feast. 4.00 Animals Aboard With Dr Harry. 5.00 Behave Yourself. 6.00 Puppy School. 6.30 Dogs Behaving (Very) Badly. 7.30 Law & Order: Criminal Intent. 8.30 Law & Order: SVU. 10.30 Bones. 11.30 Late Programs.	drama 6.00 Home Shopping. 8.00 Pooches At Play. 9.00 On The Fly. 9.30 Reel Action. 10.00 All 4 Adventure. 11.00 Escape Fishing With ET. 11.30 Bondi Rescue. 12.00 Pat Callinan's 4x4 Adventures. 1.00 MasterChef Australia. 5.30 JAG. 7.30 MOVIE: Top Gun: Maverick. (2022) Tom Cruise. 10.00 Blue Bloods. 10.55 Jag. 12.45 Late Programs.	comedy 6.00 Good Chef Bad Chef. 7.00 Deal Or No Deal. 9.30 The Late Show With Stephen Colbert. 2.30 Friends. 6.00 The Big Bang Theory. 10.30 Ridiculousness. 12.00 Home Shopping.
Entertains 6.00 Morning Programs. 2.05 ER. 3.00 A Bite To Eat. 3.30 QI. 4.00 Would I Lie To You? 4.30 MythBusters. 5.20 Phil Spencer: Secret Agent. 6.10 Grand Designs. 7.00 Spicks And Specks. 7.30 QI. 8.00 Would I Lie To You? 8.30 Wild Isles With David Attenborough. 9.30 The Assembly. 10.15 Late Programs.	Family 6.00 Kids' Programs. 4.20 Dino Dex. 4.45 Gardening Australia Junior. 5.25 We're Going On A Bear Hunt. 6.05 Knee High Spies. 6.25 The Adventures Of Paddington. 7.05 Let's Go Bananas! 7.30 The Investigators. 7.45 Caper Crew. 8.05 Secrets At Red Rocks. 8.30 Animal Park. 10.15 Secrets Of The Zoo. 10.55 Late Programs.	NEWS 6.00 Morning Programs. 2.00 News. 2.25 Aust Story. 3.00 News. 3.30 Offsiders. 4.00 Landline. 5.00 ABC News With Auslan. 5.30 ABC News Regional. 6.00 ABC Evening News. 6.15 Foreign Correspondent. 7.00 ABC National News. 7.30 Insiders. 8.35 If You're Listening. 9.00 ABC Nightly News. 9.25 Australian Story. 10.00 Late Programs.	Gem 6.00 Morning Programs. 10.00 AFL Sunday Footy Show. 12.00 Getaway. 12.30 My Favorite Martian. 1.00 The Baron. 2.10 MOVIE: Law And Disorder. (1958) 3.40 MOVIE: Golden Ivory. (1954) 5.30 Midsomer Murders. 7.30 David Attenborough's Planet Earth III. 8.40 Paramedics. 9.40 Emergency. 10.40 Major Crimes. 11.40 Late Programs.	VICELAND 6.00 Morning Programs. 3.40 WorldWatch. 4.40 PBS News Compass Points. 5.20 Myths: The Greatest Mysteries Of Humanity. 6.20 Abandoned Engineering. 8.10 Cycling. UCI World Tour. Liege-Bastogne-Liege. Men's race. 12.40 Cycling. UCI World Tour. Liege-Bastogne-Liege. Women's race. 2.15 Travel Man. 2.45 Late Programs.
9 6.00 Today. 9.00 Today Extra. 11.30 9News Morning. 12.00 The Floor. 1.15 Getaway. 1.45 My Way. 2.00 Pointless. 3.00 Tipping Point. 4.00 9News Afternoon. 4.30 Tipping Point Australia. 5.30 WIN News. 6.00 9News. 7.00 A Current Affair. 7.30 The Floor. 8.45 100% Footy. 9.45 9News Late. 10.15 Outback Opal Hunters. 11.15 Footy Classified. 12.15 Tipping Point. 1.05 Hello SA. 1.30 TV Shop: Home Shopping. 2.30 Global Shop. 3.00 TV Shop: Home Shopping. 4.00 Late Programs.	flix 6.00 Morning Programs. 10.00 Jabba's Movies. 10.30 Farmer Wants A Wife. 12.00 Baking It. 2.00 Holistic Living. 3.00 Intolerant Cooks. 3.30 Extended Family. 4.00 Grand Crew. 4.30 The Conners. 5.30 Bondi Vet. 6.30 Judge Judy. 7.30 Law & Order. 8.30 Law & Order: Criminal Intent. 9.30 Law & Order: SVU. 10.30 Bones. 11.30 Late Programs.	NEWS 6.00 Morning Programs. 3.00 ABC News Afternoons. 4.00 Afternoon Briefing. 5.00 ABC News With Joe O'Brien. 6.00 ABC News Hour. 7.00 ABC National News. 7.30 7.30. 8.00 ABC News Tonight. 8.45 The Business. 9.00 The World. 10.00 ABC Nightly News. 10.30 Planet America. 11.00 ABC Late News. 11.30 Late Programs.	Gem 6.00 Morning Programs. 12.00 David Attenborough's Planet Earth III. 1.10 Midsomer Murders. 3.10 Antiques Roadshow. 3.40 MOVIE: Spring In Park Lane. (1948) 5.30 The Edinburgh Auction House. 6.30 Antiques Roadshow. 7.30 Death In Paradise. 8.40 A Remarkable Place To Die. 10.40 Borderline. 11.40 Late Programs.	SBS 6.00 Morning Programs. 12.05 WorldWatch. 1.00 PBS News Compass Points. 1.30 WorldWatch. 2.00 Rhoda Roberts AO: A Lasting Legacy. 4.15 Nick Knowles Into Death Valley. 5.05 Jeopardy! 5.30 Letters And Numbers. 6.00 Mastermind Australia. 6.30 SBS World News. 7.35 Costco Vs Supermarkets. 8.30 8 Out Of 10 Cats Does Countdown. 9.25 Never Mind The Buzzcocks. 10.05 SBS World News Late. 10.35 Herrhausen: The Banker And The Bomb. 11.45 Late Programs.
two 6.00 Morning Programs. 1.00 The Aussie Property Flippers. 2.00 Weekender. 2.30 Auction Squad. 3.30 Harry's Practice. 4.00 Medical Rookies. 4.30 Better Homes And Gardens. 5.30 Escape To The Country. 6.30 Bargain Hunt. 7.30 Doc Martin. 8.30 A Touch Of Frost. 10.45 Ambulance: Code Red. 11.45 Late Programs.	mate 6.00 Morning Programs. 2.30 Counting Cars. 3.30 Mountain Men. 4.30 American Restoration. 5.00 Storage Wars. 5.30 American Pickers. 6.30 Pawn Stars. 7.30 The Agenda Setters: Rugby League. 8.30 Aussie Gold Hunters. 9.30 Adventure Gold Diggers. 10.30 Aussie Salvage Squad. 11.30 Late Programs.	flix 6.00 Morning Programs. 10.00 Jabba's Movies. 10.30 Farmer Wants A Wife. 12.00 Baking It. 2.00 Holistic Living. 3.00 Intolerant Cooks. 3.30 Extended Family. 4.00 Grand Crew. 4.30 The Conners. 5.30 Bondi Vet. 6.30 Judge Judy. 7.30 Law & Order. 8.30 Law & Order: Criminal Intent. 9.30 Law & Order: SVU. 10.30 Bones. 11.30 Late Programs.	drama 6.00 Home Shopping. 8.00 Days Of Our Lives. 8.45 The Young And The Restless. 9.30 JAG. 10.30 The Living Room. 11.30 The Bold And The Beautiful. 12.00 Days Of Our Lives. 12.45 The Young And The Restless. 1.30 JAG. 3.30 Bull. 4.30 JAG. 6.30 Bull. 7.30 NCIS. 10.20 Bull. 12.15 Home Shopping.	comedy 6.00 Morning Programs. 10.30 Deal Or No Deal. 11.00 Millionaire Hot Seat. 11.30 Becker. 12.00 Frasier. 1.00 The Big Bang Theory. 2.00 Friends. 3.30 Becker. 4.00 Good Chef Bad Chef. 4.30 Frasier. 5.30 The Big Bang Theory. 6.30 Friends. 8.00 The Big Bang Theory. 10.00 Becker. 10.30 Frasier. 11.30 Late Programs.
Entertains 6.00 Morning Programs. 2.10 ER. 3.00 QI. 3.30 Would I Lie To You? 4.05 MythBusters. 4.55 Phil Spencer: Secret Agent. 5.40 Grand Designs. 6.30 Claire Hooper's House Of Games. 7.00 Spicks And Specks. 7.30 QI. 8.00 Would I Lie To You? 8.30 The Outlaws. 9.30 Elementary. 10.15 ER. 11.00 WIA. 11.30 Late Programs.	Family 6.00 Kids' Programs. 10.35 Kids' Programs. 5.20 Stan & Gran. 6.05 Spidey And His Amazing Friends. 7.05 Batwheels. 7.35 Ninjago: Dragons Rising. 8.00 Young Sheldon. 8.25 Young Sheldon. 8.45 Gladiators UK. 9.45 Kids BBQ Championship. 10.25 Kids Baking Championship. 11.05 Late Programs.	NEWS 6.00 Morning Programs. 3.00 ABC News Afternoons. 4.00 Afternoon Briefing. 5.00 ABC News With Joe O'Brien. 6.00 ABC News Hour. 7.00 ABC National News. 7.30 7.30. 8.00 ABC News Tonight. 8.45 The Business. 9.00 The World. 10.00 ABC Nightly News. 10.15 Four Corners. 11.00 ABC Late News. 11.30 Late Programs.	Gem 6.00 Morning Programs. 1.00 A Remarkable Place To Die. 3.00 Antiques Roadshow. 3.30 MOVIE: It Shouldn't Happen To A Vet. (1976) 5.30 The Edinburgh Auction House. 6.30 Antiques Roadshow. 7.30 New Tricks. 8.40 Agatha Christie's Marple. 10.40 The Good Karma Hospital. 11.40 Late Programs.	VICELAND 6.00 Morning Programs. 2.35 The Grudge. 3.05 Bamay. 3.50 WorldWatch. 5.50 The Curse Of Oak Island. 6.40 Jeopardy! 7.35 8 Out Of 10 Cats Does Countdown. 8.30 The Warfighters: Battle Stories. 10.05 Does Your Partner Have OCD? 11.00 Chasing Speed. Final. 11.55 Brassic. 1.20 WWE Legends. 2.55 Late Programs.
9 6.00 Today. 9.00 Today Extra. 11.30 9News Morning. 12.00 The Hundred With Andy Lee. 1.00 Taronga: Who's Who In The Zoo. 2.00 Pointless. 3.00 Tipping Point. 4.00 9News Afternoon. 4.30 Tipping Point Australia. 5.30 WIN News. 6.00 9News. 7.00 A Current Affair. 7.30 Events That Changed Australia. 8.30 Outback Murder Highway. 9.30 NRLW Wrap: Women's State Of Origin Special. 10.30 9News Late. 11.00 Freddy And The Eighth. 11.50 Tipping Point. 12.40 Pointless. 1.30 Late Programs.	flix 6.00 It's Academic. 7.30 Get Clever. 8.30 Flushed. 9.00 Home Shopping. 10.00 The Great Day Out. 10.30 Farmer Wants A Wife. 12.00 Baking It. 2.00 Holistic Living. 3.00 Intolerant Cooks. 3.30 Extended Family. 4.00 Grand Crew. 4.30 The Conners. 5.30 Bondi Vet. 6.30 Judge Judy. 7.30 House. 10.30 NCIS. 11.30 Late Programs.	NEWS 6.00 Morning Programs. 3.00 ABC News Afternoons. 4.00 Afternoon Briefing. 5.00 ABC News With Joe O'Brien. 6.00 ABC News Hour. 7.00 ABC National News. 7.30 7.30. 8.00 ABC News Tonight. 8.45 The Business. 9.00 The World. 10.00 ABC Nightly News. 10.15 Four Corners. 11.00 ABC Late News. 11.30 Late Programs.	Gem 6.00 Ent. Tonight. 6.30 Bold. 7.00 Deal Or No Deal. 7.30 GCBC. 8.00 Lingo. 9.00 The Finish Line. 10.00 Ent. Tonight. 10.20 MasterChef Aust. 11.30 My Market Kitchen. 12.00 GCBC. 12.30 Family Feud. 1.00 News. 2.00 Millionaire Hot Seat. 2.30 The Finish Line. 3.30 Lingo. 4.30 The Bold And The Beautiful. 5.00 10 News. 6.00 10 News+ 6.30 Deal Or No Deal. 7.00 Millionaire Hot Seat. 7.30 MasterChef Australia. 8.40 Elsbeth. 9.40 10's Late News. 10.40 The Cheap Seats. 11.40 10 News+ 12.10 Late Programs.	SBS 6.00 Morning Programs. 12.00 WorldWatch. 2.00 Dateline. 2.30 Insight. 3.35 The Cook Up With Adam Liaw. 4.10 Lost Treasures Of Egypt. 5.05 Jeopardy! 5.30 Letters And Numbers. 6.00 Mastermind Australia. 6.30 SBS World News. 7.35 Chernobyl: Inside The Meltdown. 9.25 The Audacity. 10.25 SBS World News Late. 10.55 Rise Of The Raven. 12.00 Blue Lights. 2.05 Classified. 3.40 Legacy List With Matt Paxton. 4.15 Bamay. 5.00 NHK World English News Morning. 5.30 Late Programs.
two 6.00 Morning Programs. 2.00 Sydney Weekender. 2.30 House Calls To The Rescue. 3.30 Harry's Practice. 4.00 Medical Rookies. 4.30 Better Homes And Gardens. 5.30 Escape To The Country. 6.30 Bargain Hunt. 7.30 Heartbeat. 8.45 McDonald And Dodds. 10.45 Air Crash Investigations. 11.45 Late Programs.	mate 6.00 Morning Programs. 12.30 Pawn Stars. 1.30 Outback Truckers. 3.30 Mountain Men. 4.30 American Restoration. 5.00 Storage Wars. 5.30 American Pickers. 6.30 Pawn Stars. 7.30 Highway Patrol. 8.30 The Force: Behind The Line. 9.30 Caught On Dashcam. 10.30 World's Wildest Police Videos. 11.30 Late Programs.	flix 6.00 It's Academic. 7.30 Get Clever. 8.30 Flushed. 9.00 Home Shopping. 10.00 The Great Day Out. 10.30 Farmer Wants A Wife. 12.00 Baking It. 2.00 Holistic Living. 3.00 Intolerant Cooks. 3.30 Extended Family. 4.00 Grand Crew. 4.30 The Conners. 5.30 Bondi Vet. 6.30 Judge Judy. 7.30 House. 10.30 NCIS. 11.30 Late Programs.	drama 6.00 Home Shopping. 8.00 Days Of Our Lives. 8.45 The Young And The Restless. 9.30 JAG. 10.30 The Living Room. 11.30 The Bold And The Beautiful. 12.00 Days Of Our Lives. 12.45 The Young And The Restless. 1.30 JAG. 3.30 Bull. 4.30 JAG. 6.30 Bull. 7.30 NCIS. 10.30 The Weekly Kick-Off. 11.00 Bull. 11.55 JAG. 12.50 Home Shopping.	comedy 6.00 Morning Programs. 10.30 Deal Or No Deal. 11.00 Millionaire Hot Seat. 11.30 Becker. 12.00 Frasier. 1.00 The Big Bang Theory. 2.00 Friends. 3.30 Becker. 4.00 Good Chef Bad Chef. 4.30 Frasier. 5.30 The Big Bang Theory. 6.30 Friends. 8.00 The Big Bang Theory. 10.00 Becker. 10.30 Frasier. 11.30 Late Programs.
Entertains 6.00 Morning Programs. 2.45 You Can't Ask That. 3.05 QI. 3.30 Would I Lie To You? 4.00 MythBusters. 4.50 Phil Spencer: Secret Agent. 5.				

CROSSWORD



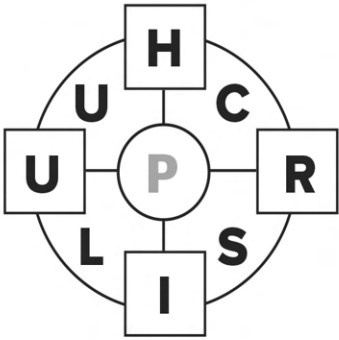
ACROSS

- | | | | |
|----|------------------------------|----|----------------------------------|
| 1 | Cicatrix (4) | 14 | Uncommon (4) |
| 3 | Newcomers to the nation (10) | 15 | Bypass (10) |
| 10 | Marriage (7) | 18 | Process of change (10) |
| 11 | Sloping type (7) | 20 | Help (4) |
| 12 | Inventoried (8) | 21 | Homeland of Sachin Tendulkar (5) |

9-LETTER

No. 174

Using the nine letters in the grid, how many words of four letters or more can you list? The centre letter must be included and each letter may only be used once. No colloquial or foreign words. No capitalised nouns, apostrophes or plural words ending in "s".



Today's Aim:

12 words: Good

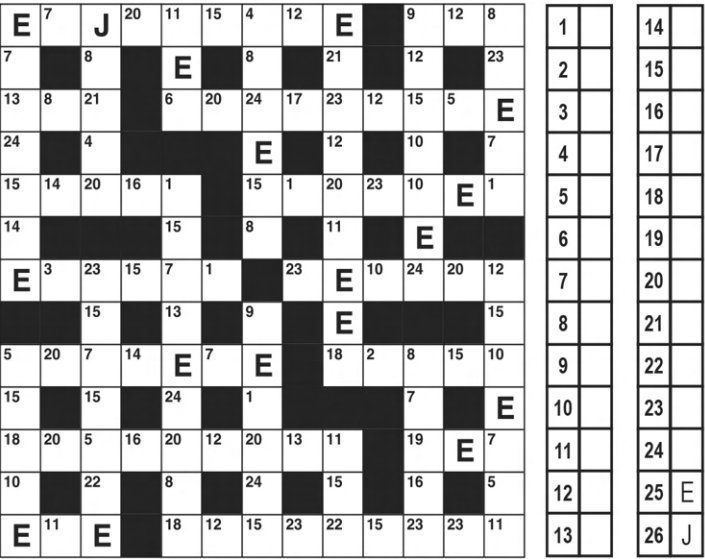
18 words: Very good

25 words: Excellent

CODEWORD

No. 124

Each number corresponds to a letter of the alphabet. Two have been filled in for you, can you work out the rest?



SOLUTIONS: 1=D, 2=Q, 3=X, 4=B, 5=C, 6=W, 7=N, 8=U, 9=F, 10=T, 11=Y, 12=L, 13=G, 14=V, 15=A, 16=I, 17=K, 18=S, 19=Z, 20=O, 21=M, 22=H, 23=P, 24=R

QUICK QUIZ

1. Tom Wills is credited as being the inventor of which sport?
2. In which Victorian city is the Cliff Young Australian 6-Day Race held?
3. What is the largest living species of fish?
4. Autophobia or monophobia is the fear of what?
5. Which Billy Ray Cyrus (pictured) album features his best-known song *Achy Breaky Heart*?
6. What year was Nintendo's Game Boy first released in Japan?
7. In which national park were the oldest human remains discovered in Australia?
8. What do you serve on top of a croque-monsieur to turn it into a croque-madame?
9. In what opera would you hear the *Toreador Song*?
10. And who composed that opera?



ANSWERS: 1. Australian rules football 2. Coliac 3. The whale shark 4. Being alone 5. *Some Gave All* 6. 1989 7. Mungo National Park 8. A fried or poached egg 9. *Carmen* 10. Georges Bizet

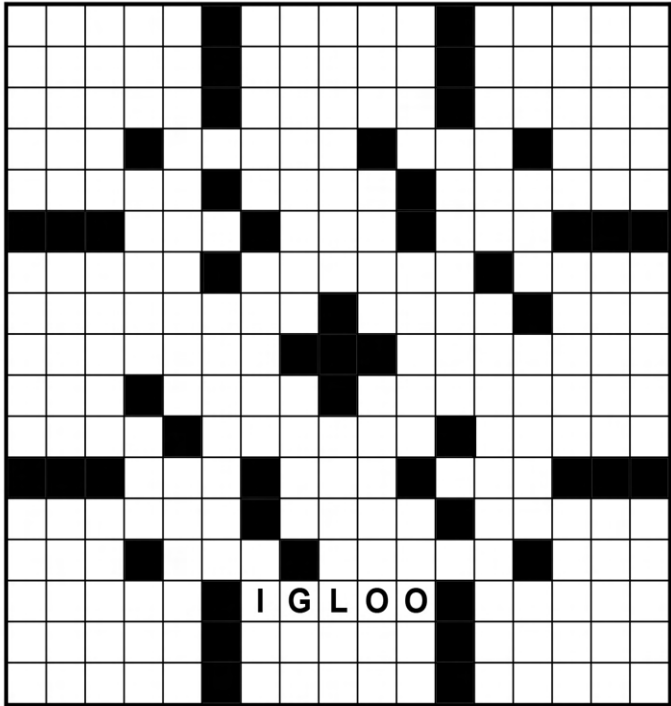
No. 174

WORDFIT

No. 084

3 LETTERS

- | 3 LETTERS | |
|-----------|-------|
| ACE | ABETS |
| ASH | ACING |
| CHI | ACRES |
| DEN | ADORE |
| DEW | AGREE |
| EVE | ARGUE |
| GUT | ARISE |
| HER | ATLAS |
| ICE | CHOSE |
| LAX | CRAVE |
| LEE | DEIGN |
| MAS | EATEN |
| MOO | EERIE |
| NOR | EMIRS |
| NUN | EXTRA |
| NUT | FLOAT |
| ODE | GENRE |
| OIL | GLENS |
| PAD | GRINS |
| ROE | HINTS |
| TEE | ICIER |
| WIN | IGLOO |
| | INANE |



4 LETTERS

- CORD
DUDE
EGOS
HISS
MAID
RICH
SEEP
SHOT
TERM
YETI
- LONGS
OUTDO
PARES
RECAP
RENTS
RESET
REVUE
SASSY
SERVE
SLOGS
SOLAR
SOLES
SOLVE
- 5 LETTERS**
- ABBEY

5 LETTERS

- ABBEY SOLVE

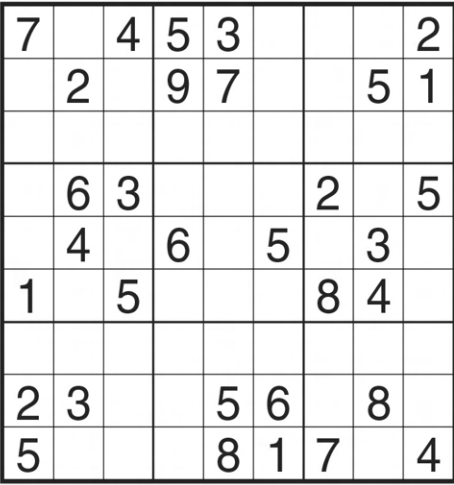
- | | | |
|------------------|------------------|-------------------|
| SPELL | NEURON | MONOTONY |
| STAYS | SADDER | |
| STILL | | 10 LETTERS |
| SUING | 7 LETTERS | DISPOSSESS |
| TEAMS | BASSOON | LEGALISTIC |
| THAWS | CELSIUS | |
| TIARA | EVASION | |
| TRAWL | HOONERS | |
| YESES | REGALIA | |
| | TUITION | |
| 6 LETTERS | | |
| CEASES | 8 LETTERS | |
| ECHOES | BRETHREN | |
| FLEECE | LENGTHEN | |
| GENRES | MESSIEST | |

SUDOKU

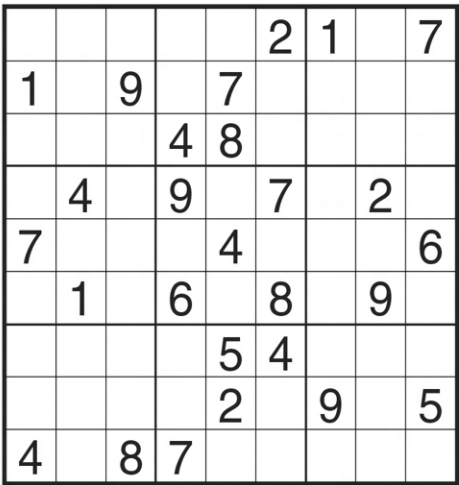
No. 174

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every number from 1 to 9 must appear in: each of the nine vertical columns, each of the nine horizontal rows and each of the nine 3 x 3 boxes. Remember, no number can occur more than once in any row, column or box.

EASY

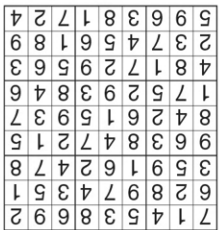


MEDIUM

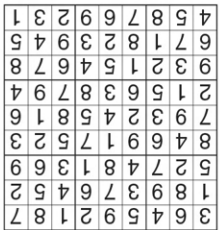


SOLUTIONS

EASY



MEDIUM



WORD SEARCH

No. 084

Can you find all the words listed? The leftover letters will spell out a secret message.



- | | |
|------------------|-------------|
| ALTERNATIVE ROCK | JAZZ |
| AMBIENT | LATIN |
| BAROQUE | LOFI |
| BOSSA NOVA | LOUNGE |
| CANTATA | METAL |
| CHAMBER | MOTOWN |
| CHORAL | NEW WAVE |
| CLUB | OPERA |
| DEEP HOUSE | PARODY |
| ELECTROSWING | PSYCHEDELIC |
| EURO | PUNK |
| GARAGE | RAVE |
| GOSPEL | SAMBA |
| GRIME | SOUL |
| GRUNGE | SURF ROCK |
| INDUSTRIAL | TIMBA |

23-04-26
SECRET MESSAGE: Dance to the beat of

23-04-26

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or

\$35 - Double column (10cm x 5cm) a week

Phone Sharon on 0407 935 998



AGRI TOPICS

Information for the
Man on the Land

For More Information
call



Mb: 0428 635 994

AUTUMN AND Spring seasons seem to be much shorter the last couple of years, summer to winter and winter to summer. Anyway, this week will see tops of 24 and lows of 9 to 10 degrees, light showers Sunday and Monday.

DPIRD drought forecast for June 20. Isolated areas across many regions in central and northern NSW are likely also to enter the more severe drought category from the drought category, where we are now. Keep in touch with DPIRD to know what’s happening

Weeds

There are 15 Australian weeds you need to identify before they destroy your garden. The definition of a weed is a plant in the wrong place. There are four types of weeds

1. Annuals -weeds that complete their life cycle in one year.
2. Biennials - weeds that complete their life cycle over two years.
3. Perennials - live for more than two or three years.
4. Woody plants - trees, shrubs.

Most common Australian weeds:-

1. Bindii broadleaf annual.
2. Clover broadleaf perennial.
3. Capeweed broadleaf annual.
4. Oxalis broadleaf perennial.
5. Dandelion broadleaf perennial.
6. Paspalum grass leaf perennial or annual.
7. Couch grass leaf annual.
8. Caltrop annual.
9. Flaxleaf fleabane annual.
10. Thistles annual to biennial.
11. Mallow annual or perennial.
12. Dwarf nettle stinging annual.
13. Flatweed/cat-sear perennial.
14. Patterson curse biennial or annual.
15. Soursob (oxalis pes - caprae) produces underground bulbs.

Get to know your weeds and how to kill them.

Dicamba m is probably the best for broadleaves in lawn.

Markets at a glance

WOOL. 16th Sydney. EMI closed 1825c/kg clean, up 39c, 44765 bales. Solid demand in Sydney for all types and descriptions pushing all MPGs up 22cto 57c day1, variable results day2. Merino skirtings gained up to 60c driven by quality, Xb unchanged, Merino crutchings and stains jumped 30c day2. NRI 1884c/kg clean, up 36 cents, 1.7% passed-in. 409b withdrawn

CATTLE. CTLX 14th. 3298 head. Lots of feeder quality weaner steers to 510c, the few vealers remained firm, 460c and 470c/kg. Feeder steers softer, bulk 400c to 502c, one pen to 526c/kg. Feeder heifers back 4 to 5c, heavy weights firm 420c to 490c/kg. Trade steers 10c stronger 460c to 488c/kg, heifers back 8c, 430c to 460c/kg. Grown steers and bullocks lifted 10c, 408c to 470c, heavy grown heifers 8c better to 475c/kg. Large offering of cows fell 15c to 20c. Heavyweights 330c to 368c, leaner 2 score cows 250c to 330c/kg.

SHEEP. CTLX 15th. 1980 sheep and 6990 lambs. Light lambs to restockers \$162 to \$235. Medium and heavy trade lambs firm to \$5 dearer, ave 1210c/kg cwt. Heavy trade 23 to 24kg \$268 to 302. Heavy lambs \$5 to \$10 cheaper, ave 1030c to 1170c/kg cwt. Heavy lambs \$285 to \$308, extra heavy \$304 to \$350. Mutton prices firm, medium Merino ewes \$170 to \$225. Heavy1st cross \$208. to \$290.

Stock Clearance continues including Round Up, poly pipe, seed and more.

Rural



Plasto & Company

Livestock and Property

Stock report by Ross Plasto

DUBBO CATTLE. 11,200. Cows and young cattle suitable for restockers made up a large percentage. Overall, a better-quality yarding with steers and heifers to suit the feeders. Limited restocker support from north, but additional from south. Young trade cattle close to firm, vealers and yearlings 410c to 490c/kg. Very best feeder steers and heifers were firm to a little dearer, most were 10c to 15c cheaper. Feeder steers 398c to 531c, heifers 340c to 488c/kg. Better restocker young cattle 10c dearer, plainer types cheaper, steers 355c to 532c, heifers 305c to 435c/kg. Grown steers and heifers around firm, steers 424c to 470c/kg, heifers 419c to 474c/kg. Cows to processors 28c cheaper, restocker cows 15c/kg easier. 2 and 3 score processor cows 250c to 337c, heavy weights 305c to 360c, ave 336c/kg. Restocker cows 120c to 332c/kg. Heavy bulls to 418c/kg.

DUBBO LAMBS. 31,000 lifted by 2600. Lambs to restockers and feeders finished \$4 to \$8 cheaper, restockers paid \$116 to \$248, feeders paid to \$289. Few light lambs to processors firm, 12kg to 18kg 2-scores \$146 to \$226. Trade lambs \$10 cheaper, 20kg to 24kg \$225 to \$299, ave 1120c and 1185c/kg cwt. Heavy lambs \$16 to \$18 cheaper, over 24kg \$275 to \$361, aver 1155c/kg cwt. Merino lambs \$10 to \$20 cheaper, trade weights \$202 to \$260, heavy Merinos to \$298. Hoggets to \$299.

MUTTON. 19,500. Lightweight sheep \$6 to \$10 dearer, better medium and heavy-weight up to \$20 cheaper. Merino ewes \$95 to \$290, crossbred ewes \$178 to \$301. Merino wethers \$141. Carcasses 790c to 870c/kg cwt.

STORE SALE. April monthly store sale 1120. Some very good quality cows and calves included in complete Angus herd dispersal from Gilgandra. Small gallery of on-lookers, most support from southern buyers.

In line with prime market, steer and heifer weaners \$50 to \$80 cheaper. Steer weaners \$380 for very light young Angus to \$1020 for good quality Angus in fresh condition. The steer weaners topped at 500c/kg, most ave 385c and 440c/kg lwt. Heifer weaners \$480 to \$780. Steer yearlings \$1300 and \$1720. Their heifers \$1000 and \$1200. Cows and cows with calves cheaper. Best were 5-year-old Angus cows with large calves, PTIC \$2700, balance in herd dispersal \$2175 to \$2550. Angus cows with first calf \$2525, balance of C/C units \$1000 for very plain to \$2500 for Angus with large calves. PTIC cows \$1580 and \$1850, dry cows \$1025 to \$1270.

WOOL. There is only a 12-month period in the past 30 years where the wool market has traded higher which was during the crossover of the 2018/19 season. The restocking by Chinese interests continues unabated and one wonders just how low stock on hand must have been. There is limited supply left of held wooll across the country according to calculations and in the past this supply coming onto the market has smoothed fluctuations in prices. It’s now all about fresh wool entering the system, so much so that Sydney has been reduced to a one-day sale this week with just 32,000 bales expected nationally. The one-week Easter recess created a larger sale last week with almost 45,000 bales. This was easily absorbed by the trade with just 2.6% passed in. The Northern region market jumped 26 cents on Tuesday followed by a further 10 cents on Wednesday. As an industry we are sitting on large welcome yearly changes that were desperately needed. Historically these changes will also plateau at some point in time for multiple sides of the industry, to hopefully make them sustainable for all and encourage a new price point at a productive level to be set for many years to come.



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WEEKLY MARKET REPORT

Week ending April 17, 2026

AWEX Northern Micron Indices Comparison

AWEX INDEX	This Week \$42/25	This Week \$42/25	Last Sale \$40/25	Sydney Change	Last Year Sydney	Sydney Yearly Change
17	2537	2508	2480	+57	1700	+837
18	2455	2434	2423	+32	1615	+840
19	2292	2262	2260	+32	1535	+757
19.5	2156	2189	2105	+51	-	-
20	2125	2133	2060n	+65	1490	+635
21	2081n	2092	-	-	-	-
28	668n	673	660n	+8	-	-
MC	1100n	1078	1068n	+32	733	+367

No holding this market back, even with larger offering

AFTER A week’s recess over Easter, the wool market returned strongly, recording large gains across all three selling centres. Almost 45,000 bales attracted widespread competition, with prices lifting from the outset. Merino fleece had the best gains, lifting 24 to 76 cents nationally, skirtings mirrored rates, cardings and crossbreds were generally better. The firmer Australian dollar didn’t detract from the upward movements, with the EMI in US terms up 68 cents at 1302 US cents, taking that to the highest level since July 2019. The EMI in Australian terms at 1825 is at its highest point since June 2019. Chinese processor sentiment is one of positivity that has rarely been seen over the past 25 years or so. Offering sizes that tended to swell when the market had a run of increasing prices tended to cap the returns to growers for extended periods, with those top makers knowing that there was plenty of wool about. The current scenario that we are in doesn’t have the wool being held back by growers, and the buying patterns that we are seeing tells us that processors know this and are doing their best to secure supply. The Chinese domestic economy is the key to this improvement, having finally recovered post Covid and seeing government policies encouraging growth and employment. Europe on the other hand is under the same financial pressures as most of the western world, with cost of living and inflation pressure limiting the amount of disposable income available, stifling demand in woollen garments amongst other things. The investment that has been made in processing in China shows the long-term outlook that is held, not only by all players in the processing side of the industry, but by the general population as well. Northern brokers and buyers attended the AWH site in Goulburn to see the proposed selling centre model. Good support is being shown for this change from the whole industry, but time is starting to get away, with the Yennora lease running out at the beginning of next year. This week is a one-day sale in Sydney on Wednesday, perhaps the first ever recorded in April, which maybe the start of the smaller quantities. Macwool and Carmichael wool will offer 789 bales.

YOUR WOOL IN SAFE HANDS

Around the tracks with Col Hodges

Racing at Tomingley

ALWAYS FIORENTE, the Bourke Picnic Cup winner on Easter Sunday, backed up on Saturday to win the 1500 metres Alkane Tomingley Gold Operations-Tomingley Picnic Cup for Dubbo trainer Clint Lundholm.

Narromine based Ricky Blewitt was again the rider and whereas Always Fiorente led throughout at Bourke, Blewitt chose to take a trail on Saturday behind the joint frontrunners My Diamond Boy and Hemsted.

Joining in at the 200 metres, Always Fiorente (\$2.50 favourite) finished best to beat My Diamond Boy (Leandro Ribeiro, \$3.50) by a neck with Allande (Dylan Parrott, \$8) a length away third.

Able to take a day off his work at a western area mine, Michael Gray, in the saddle on three outsiders, kicked home a winning treble, King Lesong, Spotted and Frenetico.

Trained at Forbes by Peter Kirby, King Lesong (\$10) led all the way to win the 800m Cracking Crutching Maiden Plate from Air Miles (Dylan Parrott, \$2.70 equal fav) and Lollylicious (Eloise Drews, \$6.50).

From the Kieren Hazelton stable at Gilgandra, Spotted came from behind the leading group to win the 800m JDP Heavy Diesel Class 2 Trophy Handicap in the closest finish on a Central West track for many, many years with race caller Tim Moses saying, “you could throw a tea towel over the first five”.

After a lengthy delay, the judge Neville Goode announced the official placings as Spotted (Michael Gray, \$8) the winner by a short half head from Corvette Pride with a nose to the third place dead heaters Shades Of Truth and Te Pani and a nose to You Count in fifth place.

So close was the finish, there were numerous punters who thought You Count (5th) may have won while others favoured the leader Te Pani (dead heater for third) to get the decision as winner.

Completing the Michael Gray treble was the Bill Hayes, Forbes trained Frenetico (\$10) which came from fourth to win the 1500m Dubbo City Toyota/Thinkwater Dubbo Class B Handicap from Queen Kicker (Ashley Boyd, \$4.40) and Kuroshinzo (Leandro Ribeiro, \$2.90 fav).

Bill Hayes for several years took horses to race over summer on King Island (Tasmania) where the Tomingley winner Frenetico had been formerly trained by Robert Keys.

Making a long trip from Wollongong to Tomingley for a single ride on a relative outsider, Paul Zerafa was rewarded when the Terry Fulwood, Narromine trained The Drafter won the 1150m O’Brian/Angus/Strahorn Family Class 3 Trophy Handicap.

Near last in the run to the hometurn, The Drafter (\$9) swept down the outside to score by over a length from Notleanormean (Leandro Ribeiro, \$2.80 fav) and Bitta Bon Magic (Ashley Boyd, \$4).

Rarely does leading trainer Connie Greig fail to win a race at a meeting and her Tomingley winner was Taxonomy (Leandro Ribeiro, \$2.10 fav) which led, was headed halfway down the straight, then responded to account for Fuel The Jet (Ashley Boyd \$2.20) and Checkout Chick (Ricky Blewitt, \$7) in the 1150m Steve Magill Earthmoving Maiden Plate.

Racing on ANZAC Day at Bathurst, Nyngan and Cootamundra Picnics and Sunday at Narromine.

Become a member of Wellington Race Club

Special deal

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Anthony Ignatius Devine – Western Freezing Works

Memories and Photographs courtesy of the Devine family and compiled by Wellington historian Marie Hoffman.
The freezing works was built on the corner of Simpson and New Streets, the site now reserve for the REACT project.

“Few country business men have had the courage and enterprise to launch out into a field of commercial endeavour in direct competition with powerful manufacturing concerns which over many years of trading had gained a virtual monopoly of the market.” Wellington Times 1940.

OCTOBER 1914, Anthony Devine entered into partnership with Vince Broderick in an export business handling rabbits and poultry with headquarters at 25 Harbour Street, Sydney.

The business expanded and soon Anthony supervised the construction of the partnership’s freezing works in Wellington at the corner of New Street and Simpson Street.

Anthony Devine was born at Little River, Victoria on September 9 1880.

He received his early education at the Little River Catholic School and later at the St Patrick’s College, Ballarat.

In 1895 he started work at the age of 14 in an ironmongery store in Geelong and subsequently worked in Melbourne before joining the Massey Harris organisation in 1899, building reapers and binders.

Within two years, he was responsible for the distribution of Massey Harris spare parts to country areas. In 1903 he managed the company’s spare parts for a large part of Tasmania.

Anthony returned to Victoria in 1904 and became the Massey Harris representative for the Wimmera district.

He resigned from Massey Harris in October 1905 and took the lease of new land on the Werribee Park Estate at Werribee, Victoria.

He farmed his estate for some years before travelling overland by bullock and horse team in 1910 to take up land at Berrigan, NSW.

After a succession of droughts, he sold the Berrigan property in February 1914.

For a period, he worked in Melbourne at Tarrant’s Motors, helping to build T-model Ford cars.

October 1914, Anthony Devine entered into partnership with Michael Vincent (Vince) Broderick in an export business handling rabbits and poultry with headquarters at 25 Harbour Street, Sydney.

The business expanded quickly. Because of good breeding conditions in the west for rabbits, it was decided to construct a freezing works at Wellington.



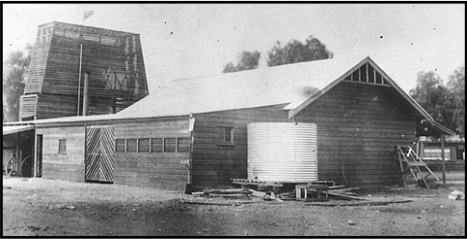
Anthony Ignatius Devine.

Anthony supervised the construction at Wellington. His versatile background gave him the skills and knowledge to establish the Western Freezing Works in Wellington and later Bowenfels near Lithgow.

Local contractors, Messrs Hodge Bros., were the builders of the Wellington factory. All the timber used in the works was local.

The concreting for the boiler foundation was carried out by Mr. W. Jennings.

The Freezing Works was opened for business in February 1915. The structure consisted of three freezing rooms 24 x 12 feet for the cool storage of rabbits and poultry. It was anticipated that 20,000 pairs of rabbits a week would be processed. The rooms were well insulated, the walls



Wellington Freezing Works on the corner of Simpson and New Streets. Years later Michael White used the yard for agricultural equipment storage and a public weighing station.

and floor being a foot thick with a ceiling of 18 inches, covered with five thicknesses of timber and two coatings of rubberoid.

The ice was provided by a ten-ton Linde compressor and because of the complete insulation, the temperature was always kept at zero.

The motive power was supplied by a 20 hp Robey engine, securely bedded in concrete and was under the care of Mr. Arthur Hamilton who had had 20 years’ experience as a refrigeration engineer.

Another staff member was Mr. J. Murphy as grader. He had 15 years’ experience in the rabbit industry.

The Freezing works relied on steam power until the 1930s when a 95hp Crossly



Marie Hoffman, whose parents had the general store on the corner of Bank and Arthur Streets, said the chocolate coated ‘Twin’ ice cream made by the freezing works was equal to, and even better than the national Streets and McNiven brands.

Diesel was installed.

Anthony’s grandson, John Devine recalls, ‘The huge oil engine was a 1 cylinder and was started by moving a 12’ fly wheel and a compressor was used to start the engine.

In later years a 200 hp electric engine was fitted’.

John also said that local stores in the area (because of lack of refrigeration) would drop off perishables at close of business and collect them the next morning.

In October 1916 the Western Freezing Co., purchased a block of land near the Bowenfels railway station from Mr. J.L. Brown.

The building of the rabbit freezing works by a Sydney contractor commenced in October and was chilling rabbits by the end of the year.

The Wellington Freezing Works conducted a large business in rabbits and poultry (both chickens and turkeys) which after proper freezing were consigned to Sydney and overseas markets.

The highest price was paid for these commodities and the firm was known for its fair and just methods of trading.

From 1923 the Wellington Freezing Works manufactured ice cream made from pure milk and cream supplied by Wellington dairymen.

The Wellington delicacy became so popular that it was stocked and sold, not only in Wellington, but in practically every main town in the west.



Blocks of ice stored inside.

It is not an idle boast on the part of Wellington to say that its locally manufactured ice-cream was equal to anything in this part of the country.

For 27 years, until 1953, the works made and supplied the ice cream.

Ice-cream was not the sole output of this local industry. Ice was also manufactured in large quantities in conjunction with the cold storage section.

Ice could be manufactured in a dozen different grades but in Wellington it was agreed that the ice turned out by Western Freezing Works was of the enduring type which made it economical for all types of household use.

The partnership had freezing works at Wellington and Bowenfels (near Lithgow) and Mr Devine supervised these enterprises from Wellington.

The partnership between Anthony Devine and Vince Broderick ended in May 1924 when Anthony Devine took sole control of the business.

After operating for more than 42 years, the Western Freezing Works in Wellington was closed in May 1957. The building was demolished, and the block sold.



Engineer Ted Dunn.

In public life, Anthony Devine played a prominent part in many organisations.

He was a member of the Wellington Progress Association for some years and was secretary from about 1917 to 1923.

An executive member of the Chamber of Commerce for many years, and of the Wellington Tourist Association from 1934 to 1938, when it was largely instrumental in the construction of the Mt. Arthur Scenic Road by the Stevens Government.

For more than 39 years was an active member of the Wellington Show Society.

Served a term as an Alderman of the Wellington Municipal Council up to 1931.

During his term, Council laid the first bitumen main road through Wellington and installed the water filtration plant.

From 1928 to 1933 was a Director of the District Hospital Board and was chairman of the Carnival Appeal Committee which raised £1000 for the hospital in 1933.

During the war, was an executive member of the Comforts Fund Committee.

A Charter member of the Rotary Club of Wellington, which was formed in 1937 and was its third President.

For about 38 years was a Trustee and member of the General Cemetery Committee of management.

He was interested in sport and for many years was an executive member of Wellington Golf Club; was a committee member of the first Garryowen Race Club of which the late W.P. Kelly was President and was a member of the Wellington Race Club in the 1920s and 1930s.

In Church affairs, was the first President of the Holy Name Society when it was formed in Wellington about 1938 and the first President when the Legion of Mary was formed around 1937.

For 40 years up to 1956, he was a member



Staff at the freezing works.

of the St. Vincent de Paul Society, and was honorary treasurer of the Wellington branch for 20 years.

Thirty-nine-year-old Anthony Devine married Agnes Reidy in St. Patrick’s Church, Warne Street, Wellington in January 1917, with Rev. Father Eviston officiating.

The newly married couple drove to the bride’s mother’s home for the reception.

They then motored to the mountains for a brief stay then by boat to Melbourne.

The family lived at ‘Roselawn’ in Thornton Street. The house, and three others, had been built by Agnes’s mother, Mrs James (Betty) Reidy, following the sale of the property ‘Roselawn’ at Suntop.

The house was rented to Anthony Devine until he built ‘The Poplars’ at 57 Arthur Street, in 1936 for a cost of £3,100.

It was designed by a Melbourne Architect.

Anthony’s son Hugh remembered that his father loved his cars. He was a pioneer this way – he had the first 4-cylinder Dodge.

All cars in these times had crank handles and running boards and a top speed of 30mph.

“Mother would not allow my father to go over 25mph. Father also at one time had a T-model Ford and one of my jobs was to crank the engine and believe me, if you did not hold the handle correctly, it was easy to get a broken thumb as they sometimes kicked viciously,” Hugh said.

A trip to Sydney or Binnaway was like an expedition, which it was. When going to Binnaway to visit relatives there would be water bags strapped back and front, an axe, fly veils, rugs etc as there were no side curtains.

“Very seldom did we have a spare tyre and all suitcases were strapped on the running board. When we arrived at the Castlereagh River, which was generally dry luckily, as there was no bridge, we had to cut tree branches to make a crossing, let the tyres down, and then pump them up on the other side, plus dig out any time we bogged. No hydraulic brakes or 4-wheel drives or synchromesh gears,” he said.

“A trip to Sydney was taken in two or three stages – no sealed roads. Father used to cut wire from a fence to hold steak, which we held over a fire. No ice in those days and I think my father was first to produce ice in Wellington and was the first with ice cream.”

Hugh also recalled that he saw great poverty during the depression.

“Men came into the yard prepared to cut 1 ton of wood for a meal. Beer was 4/- a bucket at Jaegers’ Brewery, 1/- a gallon. He saw bullock teams bring in wheat and wheat lumpers stack 3-bushel bags 20-foot-high for 2/- a hundred, bag sewing was 3/6 a hundred.

“Milk was delivered in billy cans, gas lights in streets – a Mr. Birchall used to go around each night in a sulky lighting these gas lights. My mother and grandmother took me and my two sisters Betty and Mary to the gasworks for the afternoon after we had whooping cough, so we could inhale the fumes of coal tar that was supposed to be the sovereign cure.”

After living in Wellington for 48 years, Anthony Devine passed away 17th August 1962 he was survived by his widow, Agnes, son Hugh of Wagga, two daughters Betty (Mrs J. Cox) of Collaroy, Mary (Mrs J. Martin), Wellington and 11 grandchildren.

Agnes Devine passed away 3rd January 1972.



Redbacks show grit on The Armidale School rugby tour

WELLINGTON REDBACKS Under 12s delivered a spirited performance over the weekend during their Armidale tour, showcasing determination, teamwork, and resilience across six competitive matches.

Facing a strong field, the Redbacks finished with two wins, one draw, and three hard-fought losses.

While the results told part of the story, it was the team’s attitude and commitment that stood out, with every player contributing to a memorable weekend of rugby.

A major highlight came in the local derby clash against the Dubbo Roos, where the Redbacks rose to the occasion to secure an impressive victory, one that will be remembered as a proud moment for the squad.

Individual performances were also recognised, with Connor awarded Most Valuable Player for his

outstanding consistency and impact across all games.

Oli earned the Players’ Player award, reflecting the high regard in which he is held by his teammates for both his on-field efforts and positive influence off the field.

The club extended its gratitude to Dug and Norm for their leadership and organisation throughout the tour, Grant for ensuring safe travel and Josh for his efforts in coordinating the trip.

Appreciation was also given to the parents whose support made the experience possible.

The Redbacks now turn their attention to home fixtures this Friday night at Rygate, where supporters are encouraged to come along and cheer on the women’s and men’s teams as they take on Yeoval and the Dubbo Rhinos.

Games will kick off at 5:30pm.

Washing machine exchange program extended

THE STATE government is bringing back the highly successful Washing Machine Exchange Program, helping thousands of pensioners, veterans, and social housing tenants to cut their water and power bills.

The program is helping households slash their bills by up to \$300 a year and saving hundreds of millions of litres of water.

Now in its second year, the program is offering 6500 new, energy-efficient 8kg front loaders to eligible concession card holders for a heavily discounted \$250 when they trade in their old top-loader.

Delivered in partnership with The Good Guys Commercial, the discounted price includes delivery to any part of NSW, professional

installation, removal and recycling of the old top load washing machine, and a two-year warranty.

The first round of the \$11 million program attracted overwhelming demand, with more than 5000 machines snapped up within days.

The government’s Water Efficiency Program is leading efforts to reduce water use across the state, with water savings from this initiative expected to exceed 230 million litres by the end of this round.

An estimated 107 million litres of water have been saved already, which is enough to run a shower non-stop for 27 years.

To apply and check if you are eligible, visit: Washing Machine Exchange Program.

Your sport can record results in the “Sport” section. Just contact: mark@wdleader.news

Hugh Francis is Probus club guest speaker

HUGH FRANCIS gave Wellington Probus Club an enlightening presentation as head of his new business Global Vocal Solutions, during the club’s April meeting.

He emphasised the fact that understanding of others develops where there is empathy for the other person’s situation in life.

Hugh, a successful world opera singer himself has become a motivator for aspiring opera singers, corporate businesses and anything in between.

He spoke a lot about the damage caused by continual mobile phone use by children and the need for phone discipline at an early age.

Hugh, who grew up in Wellington, was well received by the Probus audience who felt very proud hearing about Hugh’s working life and his insights into how to make the world a better place.

Gun buyback fails to make it out of the holster

The Albanese Government’s national gun buyback scheme has failed to clear its first hurdle with the majority of states and territories refusing to sign up before the March 2026 deadline, according to federal member for Parkes Jamie Chaffey.

“State and territory governments saw the reforms for what they were – changes with far-reaching consequences that had been made without any consultation,” Mr Chaffey said.

“Both the New South Wales and Federal Labor governments charged into these reforms boots-and-all following the horrific events at Bondi on 14 December.

“It was not a considered or an effective response. It was a desperate attempt to be seen to be doing something.

“These changes were rushed through without any consultation with gun owners, and they have had huge consequences for farmers, for sports shooters and

for gun-shop owners.”

Mr Chaffey said there was no word of compensation or any other measures of support to ease the desperate situation of gun shop owners and pistol clubs.

“It is just common sense that there should be fair compensation at market value for the firearms, ammunition, accessories and special equipment that are handed in. There also needs to be support packages for firearm suppliers to ensure their doors can remain open.

“Funds need to be available to sporting gun clubs for the upgrade of facilities to deal with the increase in membership necessary due to changes in the regulations.”

He said the government needed to consult with all of those bodies to ensure the compensation and support was adequate and appropriate.

“Just throwing crumbs out to these people and organisations who are so deeply impacted is

not enough.

“Two men did the shooting at Bondi Beach, but hundreds of thousands are paying the price.

“To make matters worse, the Labor Government has not introduced a single measure to strengthen our counter-terrorism responses.

“There was a huge delay on calling a Royal Commission – an outright refusal at first – and then after it was announced, special advisor to the Antisemitism Royal Commission, Dennis Richardson, retired.

“This response to a tragic event has been a series of misfires, and I am sorely disappointed on behalf of not only people in my own electorate of Parkes, but all Australians, who deserve better.

“The mishandling of this has only been confirmed by the states and territories who have walked away from the gun buyback.

“Instead of finding a way forward, we are left with no direction at all.”

More than \$1.2 million to strengthen cervical screening access

MORE THAN \$1.2 million in new funding will support community-led initiatives to improve access to cervical screening in NSW for populations which face barriers, as Australia pushes to become one of the first countries in the world to eliminate cervical cancer.

The Cancer Institute NSW has awarded \$600,000 in Cervical Screening Integration Grants to seven organisations, and \$680,000 in Cervical Screening Primary Care Grants to nine organisations.

The combined funding will strengthen access to culturally safe, inclusive and community-designed approaches to screening in priority populations.

The grants focus on supporting populations who experience barriers to accessing screening, including Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander communities, people from culturally and linguistically diverse backgrounds, LGBTQ+ communities and people with disability.

It is recommended for eligible people aged 25 to 74 who have ever been sexually active and is available through multiple service providers, including GPs and Practice Nurses, Aboriginal Medical Services, Women’s Health Centres and Women’s Health Nurses. Cervical screening is also integrated in some sexual health and maternity care services.

The cervical screening test is a quick and simple procedure that looks for a common infection called human papillomavirus (HPV), which causes almost all cervical cancers.

This can be done by a doctor or nurse.

You also have the option to collect your own sample. This is called self-collection.

Eligible people should have the screening test, even if they have had the HPV vaccination.

Canola poised for expanded role in Australia’s biofuel future

AS AUSTRALIANS grapple with current fuel price hikes and supply challenges, a new report highlights the key role the nation’s canola could play as a biofuel in future energy transition and fuel security.

The report, ‘Fuelling the future: How the new biofuel demand wave could reshape Australia’s canola sector’, by agribusiness banking specialist Rabobank, states – with the uptake of electric vehicles largely confined to passenger transport and having limited impact on diesel and jet fuel usage – biofuels are increasingly being turned to globally to help reduce emissions in these “harder to abate” sectors.

And with canola oil a key feedstock used in the production of biodiesel, this means the role of Australian canola in energy markets could grow.

The report, by the bank’s RaboResearch division, says the rising demand for renewable diesel and sustainable aviation fuel (SAF) – particularly across the Asia Pacific region – is opening a “rare strategic window” for Australia to capture greater value from its canola crop.

Report lead author, RaboResearch senior grains and oilseeds analyst Vitor Pistoia said diesel and jet fuel remain central to freight, mining and aviation, and these are key sectors where biofuels are gaining traction as a lower emissions alternative.

“For Australia, this creates a genuine opportunity to rethink how canola fits into both our agricultural system and our energy system,” he said.

Water restrictions introduced to Warrumbungle shire

From ABC Western Plains,

WARRUMBUNGLE SHIRE Council says it’s rolling out water restrictions to ensure long-term water security.

Coonabarabran began level one water restrictions on March 31. The council says Timor Dam reached 74 per cent capacity on March 12 and level one restrictions are triggered at the 70pct mark. The communities of Mendooran and Mer-

rygoen began level one restrictions on March 24, with council saying its due to higher than average water demand, limited rainfall and declining flows in the Castlereagh River.

Binnaway remains under level one restrictions, in place since early February.

Level one restrictions mean washing down paved surfaces is not permitted, gardens can only be watered between 6pm and 9am, and cars to be washed by bucket and trigger hose only.

Golfing News

Golf advisory committee elected

A NEW advisory committee has been formed to liaise with Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club board in the running of the golf club.

Members elected are Denise Haesler, Wendy Slack-Smith, David East, Elton Keeffe and Norm Royal who have volunteered for the role.

Committee members are the ones to contact regarding golf club business.

Congratulations to all the ladies on a great effort last Friday claiming a victory by three matches to two over Mudgee.

Last Saturday's events were a Stroke plus Round 2 of the Kiss Trophy.

A grade winner last Saturday was John Gersbach who finished with a 69nett on a countback. Runner-up was Barry Stapleton also with 69nett.

B grade winner who is hitting the ball great at the moment to finish with a 66nett was Charles Kensit.

Runner-up with 72nett was Brent Eather.

Prize winners were Pat Slack-Smith, Elton Keeffe 71netts; William Casey, Mitchell Cusack, Rod McMahon 72netts; Stuart Brown, Peter Holden, Gary Cusack 73netts; Neil Hollow, Doug Ney, Nathan

Stewart, Cody Conn, Jeremy Barton, Jason Neville 74netts; Allison Brien, Rod Pedron 75netts.

Nearest the pin on the 3rd Patrick Slack-Smith, 8th Robert Koch, 14th Gary Cusack, 16th Barry Stapleton.

NTP in two-shots on the 12th was taken out by Mitchell Cusack.

Longest drives went to Jeremy Barton in A grade and Cody Conn in B grade.

Wednesday's ladies played a Stroke event with Joe Ryan winning the comp with a 72nett on c/b. Runner-up was Noella Baker also with 72nett.

Prize winners were Denise Haesler and Marie Cornish with 73netts.

Finishing with a 'huge' 42pts to win Thursday's Individual Stableford was James Armstrong, with Nathan Stewart the runner-up with 39pts.

Prize winners were Rod Irwin 38pts, Nick Morrison 37pts, Drew Stone 35pts.

J and B Cup Matchplay championships Round 2 matches final date will be notified.

A grade: Kurt Cusack v Matt Reid and Mitchell Cusack v Elton Keeffe.

B grade: Daniel McCullum v Tim Parker

and Wayne Lang v Stephen Whiteman.

C grade: Rod Irwin v John Southwell and Drew Stone v Ron Cowan.

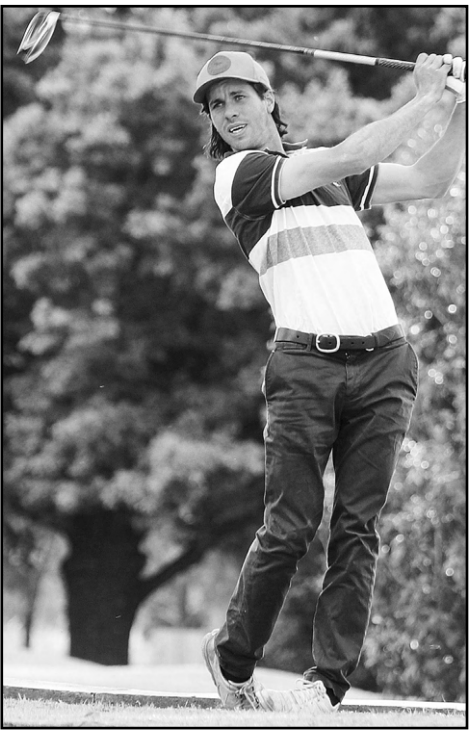
Kiss Trophy Round 2 resulted with B Kiss defeating W Bruce, R Baker lost to D O'Brien, P Neuenhaus lost to P West, D Bell lost to N Royal, B Eather defeated K Cusack, J Barton lost to C Royal, R Miller lost to J Gersbach, N Stanford lost to D Naveau, K Reid lost to J Bullock, T Parker defeated D Ney, A Ryan defeated S Whiteman, E Keeffe defeated J Ryan, J Donnelly defeated Wendy Slack-Smith, A Bullock lost to R Agar, G McNaughton lost to G Cusack, J Southwell lost to S Kiss.

Draw for Round 3 will have Brian Kiss v David O'Brien, Paul West v Norm Royal, Brent Eather v Cheryl Royal, John Gersbach v David Naveau, Josh Bullock v Tim Parker, Adam Ryan v Elton Keeffe, John Donnelly v Richard Agar, Gary Cusack v Steve Kiss.

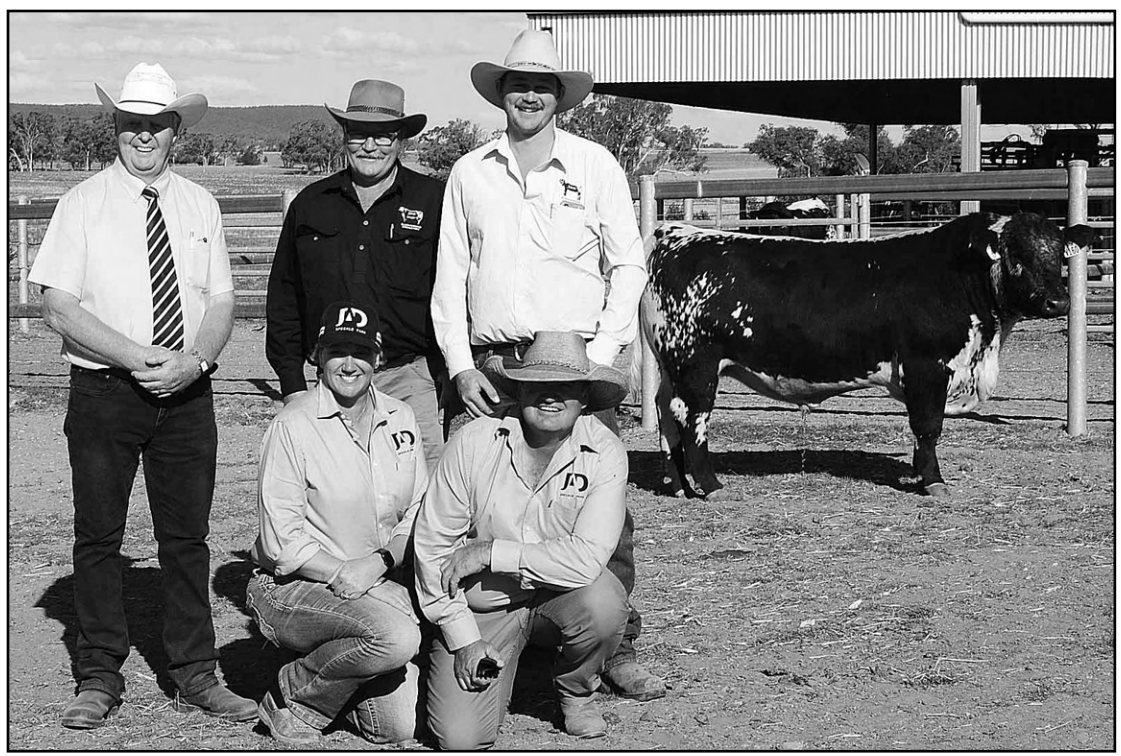
Date to be finalised at meeting.

Wellington Soldiers Memorial and Golf Club Amateur Open has been set down for Sunday, May 3 with cost and other information available at a later date.

19th Hole



Jeremy Barton hit the A Grade longest drive last weekend.



The \$20,000 sale-topper of the 8th annual JAD Speckle Park bull and female sale at Yeoval, JAD Venomous V160 (ET) with auctioneer Brian Leslie, Shepparton, Vic, buyers Andrew and Murray van de Drift, Black Diamond Speckle Park stud, Macorna, Vic, and JAD principals Amy and Justin Dickens.

In Their Sights

Fashions Mount Rifle Club

Results for Saturday, April 18.

Hunting Class: S. King 98.8, B.

Spedding 97.9, L. Hough 97.8, R.

Galea 94.3, R. Dowton 87.1, D. Gol-

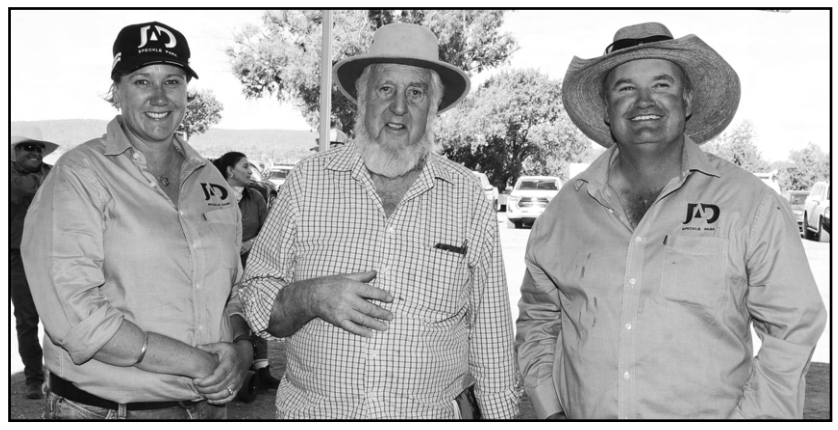
lan 83.2.

900 Yards: L. Hough 90, S. King 78.

Next Shoot Sunday, May 3 at Spring

Ridge

The Rifleman



JAD Speckle Park stud principals Amy (left) and Justin Dickens (right) with neighbour Lester Job, formerly of Moombi Shorthorns, at the 8th annual JAD Speckle Park bull and female sale at Yeoval.

JAD Speckle Park bulls top at \$20,000

CONTINUING the momentum of JAD Speckle Park breeding, bulls topped at \$20,000 and PTIC heifers to \$10,000 at Justin and Amy Dickens' eight annual sale held at Greenvale, Yeoval, on Friday, April 17.

At the sale's completion, 38 bulls sold from 46 to average \$8842, while 22 pregnancy-tested-in-calf (PTIC) stud heifers sold from 34 offered to top at \$10,000 and average \$6727.

More than three-quarters of the passed-in heifers sold after the sale.

The sale's 25 buyers hailed from four states: Queensland, NSW, Victoria and South Australia.

Buyer of two bulls and two heifers, Andrew and Murray Van der Drift, Black Diamond Stud, Macorna, Vic, paid the \$20,000 sale top money for JAD Venomous V160 (ET), sired by the \$55,000 top-priced bull of the 2023 JAD sale, JAD Sizzler S50, and out of JAD L260 Unique Q42.

This 753-kilogram 20-month-old bull sat in the top 5-25 per cent of the Speckle Park breed for all four of its selection indexes, as well as being in the top 15pc of the breed for 200-day weight and intra muscular fat (IMF).

The Van der Drifts outlaid \$39,000 for their four purchases.

Murray established his stud in 2014 on Kanimbla blood, however, the herd has a heavy influence of Waratah blood.

The sale-topper will be joined to Speckle Park stud females from June 1.

A JAD client since their inaugural stud sale in 2019, WV James and Son, Lucindale, SA, returned determined to se-

cure a number of JAD bulls for their 2100 commercial Angus and Angus-cross herd, purchasing eight bulls to a top of \$18,000 and a \$10,000 average.

Their draft top was the equal second top-priced bull, JAD Village Cowboy V245 (ET), who was sired by River Hill 60W Excalibur 345E and from JAD 300X Niome S127.

Village Cowboy V245 featured in the top two per cent of the breed for retail beef yield, and top 9pc for carcass weight.

Attending the sale were Wendy James-Ross with her son, Alec Ross, and their Elders Lucindale agent, Ronnie Dix.

Alec Ross said their Speckle Park enterprise began 10 years ago.

They kept the best of their Speckle Park heifers as breeders, while all other progeny was sold through the annual Naracoorte December weaner sales.

"The herd calves in March and is weaned towards the end of November, prior to the December sales where the best go to lotfeeders," Mr Ross said.

The bulls they bought will be joined mainly to Angus females for first-cross calf production.

Repeat clients, the Wathen family of Golden Pastoral Holdings, Yuleba, Qld, secured three bulls via Auctions-Plus to average \$9667.

Their draft included the \$18,000 equal second top-priced JAD Velocity V171, sired by Te Mooi Schwarzenager S61 and from JAD 5E Northern Star S80.

This bull featured in the top 1-5pc of the breed for all four selection indexes.

In the stud females, 16 of the 34 heifers offered scanned 8pc for IMF or higher in the week prior to sale day.

Helen Golden, Yuleba, QLD, paid \$10,000 for the top-priced heifer, JAD S50 Unique V243 - a full ET-bred sister to the top-priced bull of the sale.

JAD Speckle Park principal, Justin Dickens, said he was pleased with the support of both new and repeat buyers, and he and Amy were very proud of their sale line-up.

"We received feedback around the consistency of the cattle from several people on sale day, so that was really good to hear," he said.

The sale was conducted by Bowyer and Livermore, Bathurst, with Brian Leslie, Shepparton, Vic, as the guest auctioneer.



Wellington Warriors FC kick off 2026 season in style

THE 2026 season is officially underway for Wellington Warriors FC, with an exciting opening weekend showcasing the club's depth, determination, and community spirit. Friday night's Over 30s Women's team and Over 35s Men's team took to the field under lights, representing Wellington in their new division for the very first time.

A strong crowd turned out, creating a fantastic atmosphere and setting the tone for the season ahead. The Over 30s Women delivered a commanding performance, securing a 4-0 victory. Their energy and intensity were evident from the first whistle, marking an impressive start to their campaign. Player of the Match honours went to debutant Rachael Burgess, who made an outstanding first appearance for the club. The Over 35s Men faced a tougher challenge, going down 0-3. Despite the result, the team showed resilience and promise, particularly in a dominant second-half display.



Wellington Warriors newly formed Over 35s Men will continue to build cohesion as the season gains momentum.

As a newly formed side, they continue to build cohesion and understanding. Player of the Match was awarded to Josh Pearce, who made a strong return from retirement. On Sunday's club's Open Men's and Women's teams took on a highly competitive Dubbo Bulls FC. The First Grade women were defeated 0-7 but showed admirable determination against a younger, well-drilled opposition. Playing in warm autumn conditions, the match tested both fitness and resolve. The team is expected to grow stronger as the season progresses. Player of the Match went to another debutant, Isabelle Whalley, for her impressive effort.



Winners of their season's first game - Wellington Warriors Over 30 Women.

The Second Grade men played a tightly contested match but were narrowly defeated 2-3. It was an evenly matched game, with Wellington unlucky not to convert several key opportunities. Nick Streicher was named Player of the

Match for his standout performance. With the first round complete, Wellington Warriors FC has already demonstrated strong potential across all grades, and the club looks forward to building momentum throughout the 2026 season.

Jessica Chown

LIVE MUSIC

Emily Williams

SATURDAY 2ND MAY
STARTS FROM 7.30PM

ROCK N' MASH

Live MUSIC

SATURDAY 25TH APRIL
STARTS FROM 7.30PM

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ARTHUR STREET, WELLINGTON | INFORMATION FOR MEMBERS AND THEIR GUEST

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& Golf Club

6845 2877

ANZAC DAY
Two-Up

WELLINGTON
Soldiers Memorial & Golf Club
ANZAC Day 25th April 2026
Two-Up commencing at 2pm - 6pm
followed by LIVE MUSIC!

WELLINGTON
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Lest We Forget

WELLINGTON
Soldiers Memorial & Golf Club

Celebrate Mother's Day with Us!

Mother's Day Raffle
Friday, 8 May, 6pm
Indulgent prizes for Mum!

Special Mother's Day Luncheon
Sunday, 10 May
Lunch is served 12PM-2PM
Menu designed especially for Mum

Bookings Recommended Phone: 6845 3145
Wellington Soldiers Memorial & Golf Club